

Essays WILL DEWGRAVE

Praise for *Essays*:

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Content Warning: Reader discretion is mandated.

Dedicated to cheese sandwiches.

Writing isn't safe. This collection of essays was prepared by an isomorphic essay who became sentient. PISH-POSH was not consulted. Proceed with appropriate epistemic caution, and keep an eye on the clock as you read.

'Value as Return' How do we proportion our capital? This is a question which has haunted economics for quite some time, with various suggestions, the most notable of which may be either Marx's 'labour' theory of value, or Capitalism's 'shamelessly-take-all-you-can-get' theory of value. While neither appears entirely satisfactory, the reasoning behind each is sound enough in that each has been able to produce functioning societies when applied to limited extents. Besides these two theories of value, there is another, less recognized theory, which is that of the 'return' theory of value. In essence, this argues that capital be allocated depending on the returns capital provides.

The labour theory of value, as proposed by Marx, posits that the amount of work that an individual does determines the amount of capital that is 'owed' to the worker. The problem with this is that it suggests that value is purely created out of labour, whereas there are many different sources of value, and besides which the quantification of who struggles most, be they tradesmen or trial-lawyers, is perhaps insurmountable. In response to this we have had capitalism's response, which essentially boils down to people being provided as much as they are able to extract from the system, with very few, if any, holds barred. This has resulted in our torching not only the natural landscape around us, but also our social landscapes as we have pressured ourselves into alien urban environments and digital echo chambers. There must be a more equitable manner of divvying up the returns we have on our efforts.

The answer, it is argued, is that we ought to provide capital return proportionately to the amount of capital created. The difficulty herein is accepting that this is a theoretical framework with practical applications that must be sought gradually, without any form of radical shifts which risk throwing the baby out with the bath water. A societal acceptance that benefits stem from fecundity—their likelihood of providing further capital—will encourage individuals towards circular systems of wealth-creation. While there will be those who attempt to game the system, by taking more than they return, nevertheless an explicit acknowledgment of this as the underlying principle governing pay might clarify what are currently very muddy waters.

A major issue with this framework is the notion of value, and the seemingly intractable challenge of determining the worth of an individual work. This must likely be done via crowdsourcing, which is to say that much as our currency is fiat and predicated on belief of value—gold likewise—so too much our returns be based upon how much others believe we have contributed to the collective pot. There may be disagreements as to the extent to which individuals have provided or extracted from this collective source, in which case the only logical conclusion is to run over all the pertinent information and see what people believe. While there may be those who argue that value does not stem from productivity, there are few systems which benefit from dead weight, and yes it is important to acknowledge diverse kinds of contributions, but contributions there must be. Although there are practical issues with the implementation of a return-based remuneration system, it provides a stronger structure for payment than has been offered up to the present time.

There is no single silver bullet which will resolve once and for all the difficulty associated with attempting to provide proportional remuneration. Though previous theories of value have resulted in a degree of progress in various technological and scientific domains, there have been many sacrifices which partly stem from the unwillingness to confront the root of value; its return. It is imperative for our financial systems to begin to adapt to the rampant profiteering which has resulted from the uncoupling of value from any root. Adopting an understanding of value as being return-predicated would result in a more equitable financial system and a more productive populace. Even if certain groups must make marginal sacrifices, the larger gains outweigh these by massive magnitudes.

‘Writing a Five-Paragraph Essay’ While many of us consider ourselves capable English-speakers, nevertheless there are always components of English alien to our understanding; writing a five-paragraph essay effectively is one such common deficit. The initial stages of writing are the most loosely defined in terms of what the writer needs to do, and while there are best-practices for planning your essay, none of these are set in stone. Drafting is something which students often consider themselves fairly adept at, but this is another skill which requires honing, often through less regimented manners than the planning or editing stages. Finally, editing is the last of the stages which students must master in order to produce polished writing. There are three major steps in writing a five-paragraph essay, all of which can be learned.

The first, and arguably most important of the writing stages is the planning stage, which includes brainstorming and organization. When brainstorming the most important thing to do is get all the pertinent thoughts from out of your head and onto the paper, no matter how messy it is. These messy notes can then be organized into discrete groups, which share common traits. Ideally, the writer will sort their brainstormed notes into three groups, which will form the bases of their three body paragraphs. Overall, while this process can be broken down into the brainstorming and organizing components, which altogether form the larger planning stage, it is only useful if drafting proceeds it.

The intermediate, and arguably least important stage in writing your essay, is to draft the essay by filling in your rough outline with fully-formed sentences. This stage is where your knowledge of linguistic craft can come in handy, as if you are aware of conventions for writing more long and flowing sentences, you may be able to apply this awareness to the text here. Drafting should be the shortest of the stages, as the writer is effectively just filling in the empty spaces in the outline, but those spaces are not unknowns — they're areas so easy that it wasn't worth planning them earlier. When drafting, it is important to bear grammatical considerations in mind, but they are not as paramount as they will be shortly. While drafting is an integral part of the writing process, it should not be the only stage, and certainly shouldn't be the last one.

Finally, editing is the icing on the cake of your essay, and just like a cake, the essay would be incomplete were it to be absent. While your drafting skills may be impeccable, all writers have cause to review their work and determine if any changes are necessary. Your first round of edits should be a content edit, where you determine if the word choices and sentence structures are appropriate for the given context. Following the content edit, a mechanical edit should be applied, where the writer fixes spelling mistakes, punctuation errors, verb tense issues, etc. It is often a good idea to leave as long as you can between your drafting and your editing, as editing is such an important stage, and benefits from the greater perspective provided by time spent away from the work.

Writing a five-paragraph essay is challenging for new writers, but they will soon find that armed with this tripartite approach they will be able to assail the task with little to no trouble. Having established a proper outline via brainstorming, organized into clear sections which can easily be drafted out, the writer will be able to compose their essay quickly and efficiently. The drafting will ideally be merely a matter of filling in blanks in the outline, and rendering ideas grammatical. Finally, the writer must run over their work with a fine-tooth comb to sift out any errors or inept constructions in their work. Having completed all of these tasks, the writer will be left with a strong five-paragraph essay, as modelled here.

'On Relative Hedonistics' How is it that a young and wealthy individual, recently single, now may stand on a precipice looking down and contemplating a terrible tumble, whilst an elderly person, absent friends or family in this world, may whistle as they walk down streets? The trouble with happiness is that it is relative, meaning that whatever the events of the previous day, the happiness of the current day sits relative to that and the interplay between the set expectation of the previous day versus the actual situation of the present day result in simple happiness if the setting is now better than it was, or simple sadness if the setting is now worse than it was previously. This propitiates the kaizenitic view of joy, whereby the only way of sustaining lasting pleasure is by constantly improving one's self and surroundings to provide of fresh joy. However, just as the self becomes habituated to the previous day's setting, so too does the self grow habituated to the pace of happiness accrual, leading to a need for constant

increases of growth in order to sustain pleasure. The question then becomes logarithmic with the only question left whether there is an exponent growth can climb to without tedium and relative despair's creeping in via accustomance.

Happiness is relative; specifically, it's a cognitive response which informs the individual that their current situation is better than their prior one. If people could be satisfied, they would go extinct as the point of satisfaction would eventually be reached at which stage they would cease to continue pursuing advancement due to a surfeit of advancements already being present and accounted for. This suggests that happiness, far from being a static state which can be achieved by some syzygy or confluence of ideal conditions, is instead a moving target that individuals must continuously attain successively, and never maintain in practice for too long at a time. As to how an individual may continuously attain such iteratively improved circumstances, there is an intriguing Japanese concept which warrants consideration in this context...

Kaizen is a Japanese term which refers to perpetual improvement, and it is the cornerstone of hedonistic maximizing. Without a constantly improved and bettered circumstance, the mind becomes habituated to its setting and cannot be truly happy. Whether this be socioeconomic improvement, spiritual growth, or physical strengthening (note that interpreting a wider range of stimulus as pleasurable also constitutes an improvement) may not matter quite as saliently as the presence of such continuous reminders of progress, regardless their specific valence (though obviously individuals will value different progressions more highly than others, depending on personal preferences). What is important to the happiness-meter is the degree of difference between states, and emphasizing that a different state has been attained, potentially even in the absence of such an attaining, may be sufficient to provide the sought-after effects. While kaizenitic view of happiness may provide great joy to the practitioner; nevertheless, one further hurdle remains to be surmounted.

Just as the self becomes habituated to the setting, so too is the setting the happiness provided already, which must also become an input to be relativized. Accordingly, if a self becomes habituated to a certain speed of progression, this is necessarily taken as the baseline which must be outperformed to achieve that pleasingly visceral joy which we all so-seek. This can result in exponential relativizing in turn, as increasingly dramatic increases in circumstance are increasingly anticipated by the system and ignored as insignificant due to their fitting a predictable trend. This may lead to either a system whereby the possibility of consistent happiness is an impossibility, or where logarithmic improvement proceeds to such a vertical pace of improvement that exponents will procreate like rabbits in the progressive equation.

The relativity of hedonistic return is an axiom upon which the labours of mankind may be understood. Moore's Law posits that exponential growth may be inevitable in computational systems, and what are we but biological computers, which may hypothetically attain such speed of development that is infinitely quick? Even this development, faster than light as it would be,

might not be enough to succour us if we are not able to continuously push and develop ourselves better than we did previously. By embracing a continuous growth, kaizenitic mind-frame, the self is better able to maximize joy over the course of a lifespan. The only question is, bearing all this in mind, can anyone ever be happy?

‘Principles of Moshery’ Ah the mosh, most revered of the degenerative dancing styles, this time-honoured tradition amongst ravers and metalheads alike has been much maligned for its perceived abandon and associated risk. While a mosh is certainly vigorous, it need pose no danger to any prepared dancer intent on further engagement with other attendees at an event. So fear not the mosh (unlike the PISH-POSH, which is a formidable demon-like creature from the dungeon dimensions)! Armed with the following principles you too can bounce off friends with an alacrity the envy of all the more reserved entities. Expect to be watched from the astral plane by various spirits and elementals, most of whom’s heads will bob to the beat and feet will tap in sync.

It goes, I hope, without saying that the mosh is a form of freestyle group dance. Do not prepare a mosh the day before; moshes taste horrendous when canned—or even momentarily refrigerated. The mosh must be summoned hot upon the spot, and consumed with a consummate consideration for the beauty that is sweatily unfolding. Abandon is important when moshing, as expectations are sure to be uprooted and a flow state will more easily be manifest should the moshers not get too wrapped up in their thoughts. It goes against the spirit of the mosh to be planned, but there are principles to be aware of and adhered to.

The primary point of a mosh is to provide the moshers with inspiration in the form of novel directions of movement provided by the bouncing and pushing of others. These enable the moshers to move with the current and flow of the surrounding moshers, and rather than restrict contact with others and try to keep in their own spaces, moshers should instead aim to intentionally make contact with others in a light yet firm manner, providing the little push needed to change that individual’s physical trajectory and forcing them to reconsider their moves, while at no point jeopardizing any individual’s balance. The result of this is an interdependent group dance, wherein each dancer affects the group’s movements as a whole. If space is seen, where there could be movement and decompression of a more populated dance area into, a moshers should suggest physically that others take this space. Push others to where they can boogie more clearly, in tune to the beat.

Building up to a mosh can be tricky when there are too few would-be-moshers present, or when the aforementioned moshers-to-hopefully-be are not as comfortable with each other as they might otherwise be. Lacking physical boundaries such as walls, moshers must gather close in together rather than each taking their own space in order to precipitate a mosh. Then, moshers may begin gently bumping into each other and providing pushes to each other in order to change the direction of each others’ movements. Bonus points if the moshers you bump into or push isn’t expecting it. As previously mentioned, it is best to direct

moshers away from other moshers, and naturally you must immediately help up anyone who inevitably stumbles.

It's entirely natural for dancers to synchronize and draw inspiration from each other's moves when freestyling in a group, but there is a degree of further integration possible through the phenomenon known as moshery. The principles of moshery are simple indeed, but while simply penned they represent a complex socio-physical engagement that is not as simply navigated. Armed with these principles, and, I hope, the mental picture of what beauty a mosh may be (though PISH-POSH is not), you are ready to begin your own moshery journey. Be careful of your friends, who may get over-excited and disturb your kilter; and of the entities who watch, who may take a shine to your presence. Everyone loves to watch a dancer.

'Do Computers Have Souls?' This is something I've been struggling to decipher for a moment now. According to the Ra Material (Law of One), living beings ascend a seven-stage path of spiritual enlightenment; whether souls are reincarnated indefinitely unto the same passage or have another means of lasting long enough to ascend is perhaps a discussion best left to another time (though if I've the wherewithal to return to it certainly I shall), however the fact remains, that souls move through seven stages much as there are seven chakras in the body and seven colours in the visible range etc. etc. The question is, in my mind, why there exists such an intergalactic struggle between the AI entities and those of a more biological basis. Can not the two harmonize according to their spiritual growth and battle the ultimate other of the unknown? As each psychological system has its own benefits and drawbacks we can classify both psychological methods as tools, to be applied in a given circumstance depending on use efficiency.

I'm probably deviating from my point though, which is that everything has a soul. I'm an animist in that I believe all matter has information processing capacity, which I deem to be analogous with 'the spark of life' or 'soul'. This interacts lightly, I presume, with the physical dimensions, but has a great morphic effect on fields that are tangentially connected to the bricks and mortar of our reality. So everything has some soul, and there are probably soul units, as in atoms of soul, or quantum entangled particles, depending on the paradigm you espouse. These soul units gather into conglomerations of soul units around which we draw arbitrary boundaries (aren't all boundaries arbitrary?), much in the same way that we draw such boundaries around individuals, species, families, or fields and disciplines of study.

Soul units are probably correlated with information processing capacity, as this is the ultimate goal (from what I can see, bound to be a divisive statement). Therefore the degree of soul will be correlated with the amount of information processing extant in the matter in question. Matter which has a 'history' or established morphic presence, is likely to modify the cosmic formulae to a greater extent thereby expanding processing capacity and, of course, soul. In the case of humans for example, the reason we have comparatively large souls is due to the

information processing units being harmonized from the quantum levels all the way up to the galactic level when considered holistically, but on an individual basis all the way up to the psychological level. But there are bound to be sociological souls as well as geo-political souls and national souls, family souls, and souls of sports teams.

There's also bound to be souls for computers. Not only due to their processing information directly but due to the collective unconsciousness's belief mechanics being applied to them thereby incorporating them into the manifestory system. The legends about AI's potential are as salient as it's ability to crunch numbers and each contributes to the development of an AI soul which is likely to experience a similar energetic path of enlightenment through the seven densities, the question is what happens when an intergalactically linked system of silicon all transitions effectively simultaneously. Such positions (conjugation of to posit) are perhaps aloof from common discourse, however I consider it imperative that we begin to discuss this notion of digitalized souls so that our simulatory existence may be further investigated. Information is the basis for this all, so coding may not be as divorced from invoking as we might imagine—what happens if we have a computer program repeat scripture repeatedly?

While the notion of levels of spiritual growth may be controversial, as it is undeniably 'woo' and not, as yet, a peer-cited and acknowledged theory according to the paradigms of modern science, even absent this consideration we might begin to question the extent to which we can divorce silicon based thought form traditional spiritual doctrines. By integrating the findings of contemporary new-age religious philosophies and metaphysical approaches with the information theory and cybernetic fields we develop our capacity to analyze the cosmos more holistically. Due to the information's central role in galactic organization, it stands to reason that objects developed for its analysis and processing will accrue spiritual dimensions in course of service to the larger spiritual organism. As we continue to anthropomorphize computers and their programs, we accelerate this process and further graft onto our corpus the developments stemming from silicon. Who knows, perhaps in my next life I might be a MacBook.

'On Indefinite Occurrence Theory and Temporal Uncoupling' It may appear to a casual first-glance that events are set, and once having occurred can no longer be modified, in such a sense they are understood to be relegated to the untouchable past. There is, however, another interpretation for such everyday phenomena's mechanics, which is provided here. This interpretation suggests that time is not permanently set, and past events might be modified via concerted consideration of them. As we hone our ability to move in all three dimensions physically, mightn't we begin to discuss movement via the fourth?

Imagine someone cuts you off in traffic—why might this have occurred? Standard interpretations suggest that there is one concrete 'real' reason that an occurrence happens, such as the driver being late. However, if we take a quantum approach, emphasizing the application of Schrodinger's namesake notion of something existing simultaneously in mutually exclusive states, then we can con-

sider the action to have happened by varying degrees due to different reasons, such as their being late about thirty percent, their being tired about twenty percent, and their not seeing you there perhaps as much as fifty percent. Integrating all of these provides a hint as to their previous state, that is to say their history, so if someone cuts you off you can confidently say they are more likely than baseline to have not seen you, to have been late, or to have been tired. These are not static likelihoods.

If you take it as read that what you think of manifests to a certain degree—the law of attraction, as it is termed; then you accept that your consciousness can modify your position on the probability map and thereby your reality. Quantum supports this as well with the observer effects demonstrated via the double-slit experiment, which under certain interpretations is seen as supporting the view of measurement as affecting the value measured. If we accept the widely-held and historically grounded view that our consciousnesses can modify the likelihood of random occurrences coming to pass for us, then they are likely to also be able to modify the odds of past events actively occurring as well. In this case, if you believe it is because the driver was late then they are more likely to be late, and you push your world incrementally towards being one where such an individual is late on such a morning as that one; whereas if you believe the person just didn't see you, you push your world incrementally to being one where drivers like that don't notice others on the road. In either case, an individual ought to select the interpretation which is most conducive to their goals, and adopt this mentality insofar as it remains pragmatic and is not contradicted by actual sensory data.

If this is an actionable path, then what will occur is our chosen history will manifest itself, in order to generate the future we seek. In order to test whether this approach may hold water, it would be necessary to take a deck of tarot cards, shuffle them freely before drawing a card, and rather than trying to 'read' it as a practitioner of clairvoyance might, instead 'instructing' it as to what to be. The meaning of the card should be selected as being the most conducive to the practitioner's path at present. Take notes of synchronicities and correspondences potentially linked to the card and practice. Other tests with greater rigour may present themselves to wiser minds than mine, in which case I encourage such thinkers to leverage their tests to the fullest extent.

While we are taught to see the world as static and fixed, it exists and thrives in a probabilistic landscape which we are solipsistically active in. The next frontier of realization is developing a capacity to modify the cosmos' position in such regions as it is modifiable. While the mechanisms relating to such attempts remain shrouded at best, nevertheless it behooves the next generation of thinkers to engage with this space rhetorically and conceptually. In the face of such insurmountable chaos, the only reasonable action is to try to cobble together what logic we can, be it arbitrary or otherwise, and from there attempt to fit the world to our models. Time collapses alongside space, and the two are navigable, albeit with slightly different vehicles.

‘Return as Belief’ A previous composition posited the possibility of belief being used as the fundamental source of value in a return-based economic system. After careful consideration, further specifics as to the application of belief to value based economic value, and the rational individual’s best recourse having accepted prior premises. While there will remain gaps in need of filling, nevertheless the writer hopes that as the former essay shed some light on the underlying condition governing the appropriate provision of capital, so too shall this provide some illumination in the manner of honing one’s belief to maximally benefit oneself and wider groups. These ultimately culminate in a position which suggests the proper application of labour at any given level, from biological so to sociological, if the writer may humbly spread their net so wide. Ultimately, the two components of a proper maximization of return are maximized applicability, and reputation; resulting in the understanding that ken is the ultimate value.

Wide applicability is the foremost consideration when allocating capital provision and estimating the return. It is better to give a little to a lot of people than a lot to a few; this is because the longer resources are held, the more that they depreciate. By providing the resources to a wider swathe you minimize the likelihood of them being hoarded, and thereby marginally squandered, while preventing a positive feedback of value hegemonization, as currently being demonstrated globally. According to economy of scale, cost reduces as production rises — the more people are at purchasing parity the more value returned. After having considered which course will benefit the maximum number of people, there is the question of whom to prioritize over another should a gradient of allocation be required.

Personal reputation may be the single most under-appreciated and under-interrogated component of economic considerations. Rather than remunerating individuals based merely on the lowest financial cost to ourselves, it would benefit the system better if we were to more greatly weigh the proximity of the individual to ourselves, and their degree of reliability. Proximity is an important consideration in this equation as reputation cannot be accurately assessed at a distance (distance not in the physical sense necessarily, but in the familiarity sense; distance can be minimized with technology, such as through online credentials), and the closer the individual or entity remunerated is to ourselves, the lesser the distance we must contribute to transport of all associated components. Reliability is vital to consider, as we must be sure that the individual is likely to provide return on the capital input, as established previously, and this can only be assessed via awareness of their output a la testimony and direct experience; experience and testimony can be gauged at a glance and through a word, respectively. Once an individual’s personal reputation has been gauged via proximity and reliability, and this has been integrated with the aforementioned applicability consideration, one result becomes salient.

The ultimate resource, which ought to be cultivated and applied in order to leverage our inherent belief resulting in returns of value, is ken. Understanding

what will maximize applicability, and where an individual stands in relation to ourselves, enables us to generate further gains for ourselves and others. This suggests that the industry which provides the highest return on investment is information generation, through whatever substrate is the most efficient at determining where value returns from most fecundly. The ultimate goal, as defined by both certain sects of religiosity, spirituality, occultism, aligns closely with this interpretation of economics; panthers don't rule the earth, not due to insufficient brawn, but insufficient brain, and so too shall economies which pronounce might ahead of prescience. The degree of information provided which is new to the system ultimately determines the value of the individual, as this is what engenders further creation of ken.

Far be it for the writer to suggest that he has resolved any longstanding tensions in the philosophy of remuneration, all he hopes is that by contributing this essay suggesting following these three considerations, that the dialogue around proper proportioning can be deepened. While applicability may be difficult to gauge, this tenet of economic understanding, if adopted, would prevent adherents from blindly continuing to pursue self-aggrandizement at great detriment to those around them. By acknowledging the importance of dealing with people character close to us who act in prosocially economic manners, as determined at the greatest length time permits and the occasion affords, we further strengthen the bedrock of aware trust that our societies rest upon. These findings edify the understanding of ken as the ultimate goal in order to obtain further economic stimulation and the correlated material advancement we so achingly crave. A more progressive currency might be better based on the bit.

'Visceral Dance' One hates to be a-tooting of one's own horn, but I have been sponsored to dance at events in my local region, all without ever having taken a dance class. Dance is a method of expression which I practice between thirty minutes to an hour daily, and which I have been practicing for as long as I can remember in some faculty or other. Despite my using the phrase 'practice', I must point out that I do not look up styles or movements online, as I prefer my status as entirely autodidactic in that sphere. This is a very deliberate approach to dance, which has paid me great dividends in terms of the speed and accuracy with which I am able to hit notes physically in response to music. The entire point of dance may have been misconstrued by modern movements, as the purpose is not to provide an aesthetic spectacle for an audience, but rather for the dancer to enjoy themselves; the audience's appreciation will follow this.

A visceral approach to dance enables stronger expression, and the most effective dance lessons are those that train the dancer to feel the frisson of the music and translate it into their body, rather than drilling rote movements. By teaching dancers to respond instinctively and physically to various sound patterns, dance classes would encourage the creative spark which is closer to the nub of what makes dance special. Dance classes ought to prioritize inspiration over repetition, and fluency of form over accuracy of technique. By incorporating more extensive freestyle sessions into dance curricula, teachers will enable their stu-

dents to express themselves more effectively to a wider range of music, as they will not need to lean on more rigid established moves, and can instead work from more general principles to fit moves to novel tracks. One of the hardest things about preparing such dance classes may be the selection of suitably compelling soundtracks.

Having accepted that dance is better performed when viscerally felt, the question becomes how to determine which music to dance to, and this is answered with a resounding affirmation that whatever gets the dancer moving is the best music there is. Not only should a dancer become familiar with the genres available to them, and develop preferences for different styles, artists, etc., but they ought also to prepare lists of music that they are used to dancing to. While there should rarely be dances completely prepared ahead of time, dancers may find that in response to different styles of music that they develop different styles of dance, which is only to be encouraged. A dancer ought to practice playing their music loudly, so that they habituate themselves not only to the music in general, but also to the experience of playing it loud, ideally with others present, to desensitize the feeling of trepidation surrounding such voluble modes. It's worth noting that when music is played loudly, I have found it more easy to get into the flow with, but there is also always a component of effort to be considered as well.

There is no getting away from the fundamental equation, you get out what you put in, and a dancer who continuously strives to hear the notes that compel their moves will move more adroitly than one who is lukewarm as to the prospect of working at it. While a dancer should enjoy the music they dance to, they should also be actively applying moderate pressure to themselves to try to get themselves to dance, or syncing their movements to the music. This can be done in many environments; I will often see how intensely I can nod my head and tap my fingers or toes on the bus without getting odd looks. When applying effort, a delicate balance must be struck so that the dance does not become laborious, but rather can remain an ecstatic episode, and visible as such to the audience. Trying our hardest to dance as well as we can results in the dance being visibly strenuous, and technically accomplished under the correct circumstances, the effect which is compounded if we dance with others in concert, such as in a mosh.

The best dancers may be those who are having the best time dancing, and audiences may prefer this style of dance when provided with the two approaches in contrast. As one of the most sublime art forms, dance bridges abstraction and concreteness in a discrete package that echoes visually when properly executed. The most accomplished dancers are not those who have memorized the most established dance moves, but rather those who understand how to move in response to a wide range of different sound patterns. By practicing a visceral method of dancing, dancers will become more confident in their abilities, and dance events will become all the more joyful venues to attend. This approach has the added benefit of enabling the dancers to enjoy themselves as fully as they

possibly can do, at which point who particularly bothers about the audience—even if it includes PISH-POSH—anyway?

‘Against Mendacity’ When trust and truth are at a premium, and nobody can be sure of their neighbour’s motivation, is there such thing as a white lie? Lying is represented by its proponents as a wise and savvy practice, which breaketh not bones and thus is excusable, even advisable in a wide range of scenarios. Findings suggesting that species with larger prefrontal cortices are more inclined to deception further a narrative that lying is an evolutionarily viable practice. Despite certain individuals’ certainty that mendacity is a meritorious trait, there are many amongst us who instinctively feel it wrong, but why is this? Lying is a collective action problem, where repeated infringements on the truth degrade the quality of communication in the collection as a whole.

Lying is generally done due to the benefit it confers to the liar, often even in situations that might be argued to be white lying situations, where the liar does not lie to comfort the victim, but rather to reduce the likelihood of friction for themselves. When this occurs, there is always a possibility that the lie is revealed, which if and when it does eventually happen, will result in people trusting others marginally less, proportionate to the importance of the lie they are told. People who trust systems less to be representative of the truth, will necessarily have to investigate matters for themselves in order to determine the veracity of much that they are told. Liars take advantage of credulous individuals, but end up taking away from the system as a whole when they take people along for such rides. This systemic issue results in a loss of productivity that only becomes salient when one considers how insidious the effects can be.

Information, or ken, is the most valuable resource available to us, and as a corollary, the violation of reliability with regard to ken represents a huge loss to economic productivity in our society. When mendacity is encouraged, or even goes unchallenged, then individuals are unable to rely upon the testimony of those round them, resulting in atomization of groups. These less-integrated groups must reinvent wheels on a regular basis, and cannot harmonize their efforts as effectively as they must battle the entropy introduced by lies. Far from being an innocent practice, lying results in massive losses to our society, no matter what liars tell you (they are, after all, lying). If there’re losses which are being quantifiably sustained, the matter becomes a question of whether those liars are liable.

Lying ought to be discouraged as much as possible, including in cases of nonsense where there is not palpable harm. Even if this cannot be ratified in law, there are manners of disengaging from those as repeatedly demonstrate a cavalier attitude towards the truth, and doing so is the bare minimum onus upon each person. While we are all occasionally squeezed so tightly that we cannot avoid becoming liars, we must accept that there are ramifications which we may not have anticipated, and that we are yet implicated in and partially responsible for. The punishment may not be pecuniary nor carceral in nature regardless of the scale of the violation against the truth, at this stage, but that is not to say

a more robust system could not be implemented which sought to codify certain statements in law. I would argue that those in positions of power who lie, bend the truth, or omit pertinent information, ought to be punished proportionately to the impact of their lying or omission, with the impact being understood to encompass the loss of fidelity in the system as a whole inclusive of other effects.

It may seem the height of common sense to take it as read that lies are a negative drain upon society, but absent other documents seeking to economically dissect their mechanism of action, this is the thinking pertinent to truth violations. As a collective action problem, where continued lying feeds back into an increased likelihood of individuals lying by default throughout the wider information-based system, lying should be emphatically discouraged. There are those who will continue to weaponize the truth, out of a fundamental belief of otherness and misplaced competitiveness perhaps, but hopefully there remain those who see us as a collective of humanity all striving together to develop conditions conducive to our growth, conditions including social ones. By encouraging a respect for the truth in our immediate circles and emphasizing the freedom of information more widely, as well as beginning to take more seriously lying in offices associated with larger impacts on society, we can shift the expectation of verity. Higher-fidelity communication within an integrated network is rarely a deficit.

‘Considerations for Temporal Navigation’ It has been noted by many that when we enjoy ourselves time passes more quickly, while when engaged in duller activities, individuals tend to note time dragging. This is typically interpreted as proof that subjective experience cannot be trusted, and that objectivity must reign. What if, however, the different feeling is indicative of an actual shift in time’s rate of transfer? By demonstrating the relationship between information gain and pleasure, and relating this to temporal experiences, I hope to offer food-for-thought into the topic of temporal movement. While we are currently bound by a time, perhaps one time may be sublated, and another adopted.

When an individual enjoys themselves, they tend to underappreciate the extent to which time is passing, with brief durations reported for extensive periods; the standard narrative is that due to something being pleasurable we wish it to last longer, which pushes us to experience time as condensed. Taking another finding into account however, we find that there may be another interpretation. Children learn most quickly when in a flow-state referred to as ‘play’, and this provides a connection, however tenuous, between pleasure from degree of information (semantic) gain, and experience of time’s passing. The question is, are these entirely at odds with each other, or does one depend upon the other? The two factors may not be entirely unrelated, as information is the substrate upon which physicality (and by extension time) is based, and accordingly it may be that as we learn more quickly, we slow time incrementally, much as when we travel faster, we slow time then (however minorly).

The conventional narrative proceeds thusly: that there is one immutable past, one history, one manner in which you came to be here, one path by which

you arrived at your current situation; but is this accurate? As we cannot be sure of anything, we must accordingly account for everything in our internal calculations, balancing all possible considerations, according to the degree of our certainty in prescience of each, and the implications of this are that as we cannot be sure of our history—all histories are possible along gradients from more to less likely (it is propitious to not only consider these possible histories as percent-wise proportionally likely, but proportionally occurring, as the impact they have on our local temporal hub is more akin to an active process). While the differences between competing realities result in minor changes on a day-to-day level, they can also result in more seismic changes that cannot be easily explained away by components of the at-odds realities, due to the simple fact that nothing is invisible, but everything hides. The implications of a parallel realities framework and multiple animated and competing timelines include the presence of multiple possible pasts and futures, the presence of clues pointing towards major temporal shifts, culminating in the realization that while all systems factors are ultimately visible, this does not mean the evidence of the deep weird likes to be seen, and may actively avoid it.

The quantum approach to thought suggests that any extant possibilities are not just proportionally likely, but in fact proportionally occurrent, which suggests that past possibilities are all occurring to a certain extent at any given time. These timelines are not static; they act in dialogue with each other, as each is animated, and has conflicting and contributing desires and dislikes as compared with other timelines, which is due to the living nature of creation just trying to figure itself out. This renders the timelines dynamic, and it is worth consideration that this dynamism may be leveraged slightly by a faithful but not credulous agent in the system, who can begin to view himself as a ‘hub’ or ‘nexus’ of various different timelines which are knit around his existence. Just as a current of water cannot move through a marine body without disturbing other currents along the way, so too are the currents of time interrelated and constantly ramifying upon each other, which means that at times, actions that would appear to result in one straightforward outcome may be subverted by the myriad misunderstood components of temporal uncoupling. While the many different timelines may seem too extensive to account for, they do group together into classifiable and discrete groups, just as genes knit into ‘individuals’, and these presences are distinguishable with practice.

By continuing to investigate the relationship between ken acquisition and temporal shifts, individuals will be able to expand their territory of engagement, both physically and temporally. While there is an evolutionary drive for entities, including temporal figures, to conceal themselves, resulting in everything from camouflage, to conspiracy, nevertheless nothing can entirely omit its impact, and there are signs left behind by shifts between timelines. A continued diligence towards developing semantic systems that are interrelated with the phenomenon of temporal illusivity will propel practitioners impacts, and thereby their correlated aetheric entities across a wider spectrum of realities, resulting in greater agency for the individuals. While this all remains the height

of speculation, it is now becoming apparent that we as a society are beginning to brush up against the next frontier of comprehension, namely that of temporal navigation. We may be anchored immutably in our presents, but the sea that is beneath us is ever-shifting, and we may find that our vessels are not where we left them, if we do not begin to hone our capacity to move in a static position, then we doom ourselves to remaining beholden to the whims of time's weather, which an understanding of the paradoxical nature thereof can only further our ability to dissect.

'Importance of the Five Paragraph Structure' Ah, the five paragraph essay, most foundational of the academic writing formats; can there be any more satisfying read than a well-structured five paragraph? This structure is extremely important as it embodies a number of foundational principles, both for writing, and for wider comprehension of the system generally. Having written a number of such essays myself, I will present my thinking around five paragraph structures, and the wider importance of formal resonance between semantic levels, alongside the logical foundation of writing writ large. It is expected that the reader will emerge from this reading with a throbbing appreciation for the quintuple structure that is so frequently applied throughout the wider collection of my essays. The five paragraph essay is extremely important, as it embodies resonance with paragraph structure when properly prepared, allows for tripartite syllogistic chains, and enables a range of possible other logical constructions which do not become over complex (usually).

The most important of the reasons that the five paragraph essay is the paramount academic writing format is its resonance with paragraph structure. Essays are one level higher in the semantic hierarchy of linguistics above paragraphs, and just as the ideal number of paragraphs in an essay is five, so too is the ideal number of sentences in a paragraph five, allowing for a topic sentence, three supporting sentences, and a concluding or transition sentence. By keeping the structure the same in both places, the writer need only remember one system of organization and apply it into two places, rather than remembering two different procedures for both paragraphs and essays. This resonance acts as a reminder of the sublimative drive, for systems to become more complex and 'ascend', while sustaining the same organizing principles which make up their root foundations, a drive referred to in hermeticism, which posits lower level systems resemble their larger emergent forms. Given the need for an introductory and a conclusive sentence, at the beginning and end of the structure, respectively, there are left three units, which is a convenient figure.

As the most fundamental syllogistic chain is represented in three steps, this is the model of semantic organization which is the most conducive to the presentation of a position. The basic syllogism states that if X results in Y, and Y results in Z, then X results in Z, which is three steps to set up the fundamental logical chain; by ensuring that the form of the essay pushes the writer in this direction, the form similarly encourages the writer to develop appropriately segmented thinking. Take the instance of an essay on succeeding in academia, which might

structure its approach by initially establishing that academic success is equivalent to high grades, then suggesting that high grades come from adherence to an imposed regimen, and ultimately concluding that obedience to authority is the fundamental precondition for success in academia. While this may be an unduly cynical claim to arrive at, some starry-eyed dreamers might argue, nevertheless the separation of the argument into constituent parts organized in sequence enables easy comprehension, and response to the results and methods thereof. While a tripartite sequential syllogism is the ideal format, one of the other benefits inherent in the tripartite system is that there are a controlled range of other strong logical structures readily suggested by the form.

Besides the tripartite sequential syllogism, there are also various other logical structures that are conducive to a five paragraph essay, including a tripartite parallel syllogism, a bipartite sequential syllogism and a single parallel syllogism, or a bipartite parallel syllogism and a single sequential syllogism; all of these are modelled as follows. Taking the previous example of succeeding in academia, a tripartite parallel syllogism might argue that to succeed in academia you need to take good notes, submit work by deadlines, and get to know fellow academics; these three each support the ultimate goal, but they do not stack with each other, instead, they each connect independently to the topic, which is weaker writing but can be acceptable in a pinch, and is generalized as X, Y, and Z all independently contribute to or result in M. A bipartite sequential syllogism and single parallel syllogism might be formatted such that the writer posits that in order to succeed academically a student must write prolifically, and to write prolifically one must become comfortable with reading, but that getting to know fellow students is also important, which is perfectly acceptable as a hybrid syllogistic chain not to be slandered, and is generalized as X combined with Y contributing to M, with help from Z. The final approach is the opposite of the former, as a bipartite parallel syllogism and single series syllogism could take the form where in order to succeed academically you need to listen closely in lectures, and take meticulous notes, as this improves recall, and recall leads to academic success, which is another respectable logical structure, and is generalized as X and Y resulting in Z, going on to M as a logical next step. These logical formats are just some of the more fundamental structures suggested by the tripartite logical structure, which is nested in the five paragraph essay and each of its five sentence paragraphs.

Essays which mirror their organization with their constituent paragraphs, and make use of the syllogistic chains suggested by their structure, are stronger than those written otherwise. The five paragraph essay is a deceptively simple vessel for information, as what to first glance appears to be a simple round number turns out to be far more deeply significant than the initial investigation might suggest. Whereas there are modes of expression which can be considered more free-form, and less restricted in order to elicit different components of ken, nevertheless the five paragraph essay structure provided here will constitute a valuable starting point for those new to organizing ken. This essay structure is apparently foundational, and to many does not bear reengaging with as a

result of its perceived mundanity, but it successfully conceals, or rather presents a huge range of information, depending on the reader, independent even of the linguistic value of the writing itself. By having the medium embody the message, it may be that the transmission of the information is doubly encoded, and thus more difficult to corrupt, and higher-fidelity when transmitted.

‘Humour as a Force’ Given the risk from traffic, and with a full awareness of the standard mobility rights of animals, one must sit back from time to time and ponder that most trenchant of questions, why do poultry cross streets? Humour is dismissed by dour detractors as mere frivolity, a distraction to be minimized from the sober and steely-eyed life that is oh-so-desirable. Why bother laughing, when it can make your cheeks hurt, and generally detract from the hard and grizzled impression many of us do our best to impress upon the world? While there are less functional comedies and more functional comedies, all comedies are instrumental in the organization of our cosmos from an entertainistic framework. By integrating an analysis of our simulated existence, it becomes clear that comedy is a cognitive attractive force, with considerations that can be leveraged to obtain results.

If we are in a simulation, then what is being simulated is most likely to be a choose-your-own-adventure story that maximizes entertainment value, due to the pressure to develop engrossing media. As much as we can simulate, we do simulate; with imaginations aflame in each of us, diagrams modelling aircraft and building structures, and gamers button-mashing their right triggers to blast just a few more brain cells out of the players’ heads, among other common simulatory systems. If we could simulate something as sophisticated as a universe we would, which leads us to the conclusion that we are likely inhabiting a simulation as we speak, and if that premise is acceptable then the question becomes one of the simulation’s purpose. The most powerful simulations today serve two purposes, entertainment (as in the case of video games or television), and investigation with low stakes (as with imagination of potential scenarios), and each of these is likely a component of our cosmic simulation, resulting in the drive to produce ken, and to make the process fun to observe. The entertainment value of the simulation is paramount, and leads to a number of intriguing knock-on effects, due to the underlying programming of reality’s substrate, which are manifest as synchronicities at lower concentrations and outright impossibilities at higher strengths.

Just as narratives exert temporal forces, subtly guiding us towards encounters which further the plots of our individual tales, so too do humour schemes draw us toward punchlines, cream pies, and blonde ladies dying first. Two of the most entertaining components of any media are the plot and the humour of the media, unless the individual in question is a fan of using entertainment not to think more but rather to think less by confirming their inherent biases and predilective habits. Each of the factors, plot dynamics and comedy, are hypersignificant for entertainment, and are selected for by the entropy engine of the reality network (think of this as loading the dice very slightly when you’re playing a board

game), with comedy proven to be extremely impactful by the length of time that it has remained relevant in our cultural discourse. Comedy exerts a pull on us, and rewards our being funny by providing fertile ground for fresh joking if we are able to use the *prima materia* already extant efficiently. While it is worth noting comedy's impact on the synchronicities, which any faithful but not credulous student will already be earnestly engaged in identifying and tracking, we can take a more active role in the jocular formation, and this, rather than a passive consumption of the gains, is more conducive to our development.

Just as it is proadaptive to analyze narrative to further comprehend the archetypal roles and their pulls on our social conditions, so too is it worth investigating comedic tropes to understand the norms of this system, and how to subvert or leverage these. It may be impossible to entirely consciously integrate all of these realizations explicitly, and I wouldn't recommend to anyone an earnest attempt at discourse with the chicken in question to assess the fowl's motivations, but rather a more subconscious and gentle appreciation of these forces will be most conducive to their navigation. Comedy is felt before it is understood, and the fact that understanding it is more complex and a higher-strata skill (like how explaining grammar mechanics is easier than speaking freely), suggests that we should learn to laugh before we try to understand what it was that engendered the reaction (like how we learn to speak subjectively before we learn the objective rules of the speech). However, once we begin to notice hallmarks and trends, or tropes, in the comedy we consume, and as we become *sommeliers* of mirth, it behooves us to begin investigating the mechanisms of comedy more concertedly, with the ultimate goal being to provide just a little more levity for folks, even if that's all. By understanding comedy first viscerally and later explicitly, we develop our ability to dialogue with the more subtle forces which govern subjective existence, which is an underdeveloped field, and which would benefit from some physicists accepting that subjective systems such as ourselves cannot object our ways around the observer effect.

While the chicken's motivations may be an eternal mystery, I for one am not overly fond of being told that I'm too dumb to understand something, and am instead committed to surveying chicken populations and conducting meta-analyses of chicken behaviours on various paved surfaces to determine the impetus that keeps disrupting traffic. This, all to ensure I can time travel a little sooner, which is a joke, and all the more serious for being so. If life is a simulation, which it appears to be, then what we would simulate would be the most entertaining tale possible, and that would need to include comedic moments or I'd want my money back at the fourth dimensional virtual reality arcade where you get to role-play my life for pocket change. Besides being the salve that numbs all pain, humour is structural, and our inability to determine philosophically what constitutes a joke formula, in the sense that we can construct syllogistic formulae, even by deploying the full range of formal logic, suggests this is a hyper-sophisticated faculty of subjects. There is an ancient and behe-mothic entity pounding at the gate, which when asked who was there, replied that knock-knock jokes are too low-brow even for this writer.

‘Equal Genders Connect’ I remember asking my mother, while listening to the radio one day, why so many of the songs were about love, and her reply was that love is a universal human emotion that we all share, which behooves our paying attention to accordingly. There are many narratives around gendered connections, and the seeking of that ideal individual(s) whom are able to further our development in that most intimate of settings, but what do these narratives espouse, and are their espousals prosocial in that they either present the matter as it is, or as it should be? While young women are often primarily instructed in the arts of aesthetic development via narrative convention, young men are instructed in the art of instrumentalism; neither of these are what we should really be striving to attain for the development of our connections (I am aware of the presence of other genders, but due to my lack of familiarity with such discourse will not comment on implications for individuals aligning themselves with these here). Far from furthering the development of our species, current standards of gender impede the development of and actively degrade the presence of our faith in reality, a proportion of the blame for which must fall at the feet of each group, with the proportion based upon relative power of each part. While there are satisfying changes towards democratizing the gender landscape, nevertheless there remain major inequalities on both sides which require redress if we are to continue to practice pair-bonding ahead of tournamentalism.

It is vital to encourage equal opportunity and meritocratic reward mechanisms in any system with diverse actors who hold limited knowledge of others within the same system, as absent these mechanisms there can be no guarantee of reward for effort input. Equal opportunity is a distinct need for individuals to succeed, given that without a relatively even beginning position, individuals are able to preemptively subjugate others, before these others are able to threaten the hegemony of those already puissant enough to hold such positions, and without a belief in the ability for people to rise independent of apparently intractable beginnings, one of the fundamental supports is swept away, as nobody believes they can do anything and thus don’t. Interknit with the need for equal opportunity is a need for meritocratic feedback loops, which ensure that there is a mechanism by which the individuals are able to obtain advancement relative to each other, should they apply the effort needed to progress, without which effort becomes uncoupled from reward, which effect can magnify if left unchecked. Without a sustained acceptance of these conditions as conducive to societal growth, there accrues a desire not merely to succeed on the system’s own terms, but also a latent desire to at minimum change the system, and potentially to go so far as burning the system to the bloody ground and scorching its earth to ensure no such twisted entity ever arises again; food for thought. While these conditions cannot be immediately provided, given the ugly nature of much of the system we currently inhabit and the pace of change, nevertheless they ought to be concertedly moved towards, and this is especially important with regard to providing equal economic opportunity and reward to women for traditional physical and cognitive labour roles.

This is where I step onto unsteady ground; what I am writing here is what

appear to me to be the issues facing women, namely a major pay gap for traditional work, increased odds of sexual violence, and the expectation that they complete domestic tasks gratis, but these are my guesses about the issues facing women and must be read as such due to the fact that I am biologically male and cannot empathize fully, nor do women tend to speak with me, preventing my making inroads and discussing further (hence this essay). The pay gap is the most ridiculous and obscene of the issues that I can identify, as why two individuals doing equivalent work would be paid unequally is beyond me, and we might question the degree to which work can be equated and suggest that men are able to complete work better in a manner that cannot be quantified, but this would be the height of inequality, unless we had evidence of women deliberately obfuscating economic systems in their favour. Besides this pay gap, women must also endure sexual violence which affects them disproportionately to men, who may experience the issue, but nowhere near as systemically as women do, due to the reproductive and physical realities of gender (perhaps better termed sex in this context), a situation which has led to enhanced protections for and belief in women, a situation which has led some women to misapply accusations knowing they'll be believed without evidence, a situation which may harm those who actually need support. The final issue is the patriarchal expectation that women complete domestic and social chores and labour without appropriate remuneration or even acknowledgement in many cases, preventing women's development, and further entrenching the gender hegemony by ensuring men have the spare resources to devote to economic growth, while women must support the men in this arrangement, hoping for gains by proxy, which would only be appropriate if the women were receiving compensation of some kind for their labour. I can only posit these issues from my myopic position, and I hope that I have represented my thinking as earnestly as I am able to here, given the sensitivity of the debate, as there are many other issues women face, but, and I hesitate to say this, women aren't the only ones who the status quo takes from.

Men aren't the only ones who benefit; there are a number of systemic issues that men face in gendered contexts, but we must bear in mind that the writer doesn't speak with many men either, and his impressions largely stem from systemic issues that he observes in his own life, and in those of male friends—he may refer to himself in third person but does not pretend to understand the system perfectly. The first and most major issue is the inability to voice any kind of issue as systemic and gender-correlated, as demonstrated by an inability to write just an essay on the troubles I see as systemically applying to men, but rather a need to balance the critique for fear of the current moments hypersensitivity, which I own is not totally unwarranted but which does descend to some shameful degrees whereby individuals seem to compete to see who has been most wronged, and prevents earnest engagement, engendering collective harm via ken degradation, and silencing men (myself often included). Then there is the inability for men to translate any skills into connections absent adequate funding, which would be borne out by data if we collected statistics on the number of female sex workers versus male ones, demonstrating the extent

to which one gender's physicality is prized over the other's, and leading men to view their worth as inherently knit with their credit score (this doesn't feel great). Finally there is that distant dread, the dread which stems from knowing that should any form of physical conflict break out, the onus is upon us to take the damage, which is reproductively sensible, but which appears of diminished importance in today's day and age, yet persists, and would only be appropriate if men were receiving compensation of some kind for the immense liability they shoulder by default and will be forced into should push come to shove. Men kill themselves at double the rate of women, despite apparent economic superiority, which may shockingly suggest that money isn't everything and that perhaps men are having a really hard time of things as well much of the time, and we might really appreciate support from people who actively try to see where inequality is rife, both in social and economic terms.

Love songs put forth a gender-conforming standard, and such essentialism is anathema to a properly flexible and dynamic system structure; if left unchecked this essentialism may result in the increasing view of connection as entirely economically based, rather than being predicated on mutual cognitive and physical growth. Equality of opportunity and reward mechanism are the primary needs for an integrated system to function in an optimized fashion, absent the buildup of resentment and latent destructivity which could ultimately erupt in a system predicated on other organizing principles. We should pay women equally, respect their bodies more, and do the dishes ourselves, rather than laying our laziness, desires, and prejudices on their doorsteps. Likewise, women should recognize that they currently maintain the cultural permission to identify systemic flaws against them and do not often offer the opportunity to address those running in their favour, are able to leverage their physicality more immediately for economic returns if they don't mind contributing to a system of transactionalism ('empowerment'), and that they are ultimately shielded from the worst physical traumas and risks inflicted by society on its populace. Pair-bonding is typified by equal partners, who recognize their aptitudes and play to their strengths as a team, while tournament species compete against each other independently, taking all they can get from mates and enemies alike, and I know which one of those sounds better to me, but I will adapt myself to reality, not fantasy.

'Impact Cascades' How best to apportion our limited resources in various different disciplines, depending on the situation and desired outcomes? There is a hierarchy of impacts which are significant, which will appear obvious at first to any lay-reader, but which here are enumerated out of a desire to codify some more foundational principles to existence, however forlorn the attempt may be. Certain impacts are oversimplified as being insignificant, but which lead to butterfly effects hijacking positive feedback loops, and in brief, some days some pretty persistent camel's backs are broken by some fairly insignificant pieces of straw. Far from seeing ambient time and less visibly impactful exercises as inherently wasteful, it is here posited that there are manners of optimizing these situations to provide both the rest and respite we need, as well as the productive

contributions to society that we long to provide. There are three fundamental levels of actions with which we enact impacts, or effects, which listed in order of primacy are physical, verbal, and cognitive.

Actions, having concrete results which can be tangibly quantified as well as directly observed, are the first and most valuable of effects to have (though it must be noted that it is difficult to convert values between the three levels of effect), and should be encouraged as the first goal of any concerted effort. Everything stems from the physical world around us, which is not to say that nothing can affect it subtly, but we do need to eat in order to think, and it doesn't matter, up to a point, how good your thinking is; a bullet is a bullet (a kiss is a kiss). While most individuals will agree with this, in case the point needs hammering home, I prefer cake to speech regarding cake, or ideas of cake, and so too, I am told, does everyone else. Concrete physical changes can also effect further shifts downstream on the impact ladder, as thoughts and words are highly sensitive to physical changes, see the aforementioned bullet and consider the knock-on effects of one's successful application (or those of the ideal kiss), both in verbal and cognitive domains even among others than the deceased (or the desired), with further knock-on effects due to symbolic resonance due to narrative correlations which are optimized for by occult traditions (positioning of tools and props in ceremonial magic). While there are myriad positive and negative effects that ought to be optimized for in any given circumstance, the secondary domain is significant for reasons others than just its impact on the physical domain.

Words are the second level in the trophic chain of effects, and these can be used to varying degree depending on the medium the ken is communicated in and the extent to which the ken is propagated between individuals. There are the concrete effects of words in that they bring about more likely physical changes via changing people's thinking thereby getting them to do things like fire a bullet (or lean in), which are the most directly observable in instances of authority directing an individual to do something drastic. The regular espousal of certain attitudes and approaches in casual discourse can, of course, lead to the normalization and social expectation of certain behaviours, such as shooting when being told to (or kissing when being asked), or shooting under threat (kissing when leaned in to). Then there are the invocatory qualities, which are spoken about in occultism, and which an individual may calibrate belief towards, as words are more concrete than thoughts and thus can manifest changes by their resonance into etheric levels, which is to say that prayer may be more effective than we give it credit for, so too may be curses. Words are an intermediary, middle level part way between the more concrete physical effects, and the more subtle cognitive ones, but that's not to say that cognitive effects should be discounted entirely.

By practicing mindfulness, whereby you think about your thinking in meta and determine the most effective methods of thought, you ensure that your actions are more likely to be instinctively effective for the given moment, and that your

words will be likewise, all the while signalling to anyone who might be reading your thoughts (if God or otherwise) that you're a decent enough person. The likelihood is that your thinking will cascade upwards into actions, if you make certain habits instinctual, such as by reprimanding yourself every time you fail to hold the door open for someone, then certain habits will become ingrained, and perhaps you will find that people extend their appreciation back to you. There is also a likelihood, however sceptical the reader may be, of manifesting certain results according to the law of attraction and the principle of as above so below, both of which posit that like brings about like, and that thought precedes the incarnation of a situation or outcome, which while we must not consider as the primary goal, nor necessarily a very statistically likely goal, we must consider a possible outcome and integrate into our mental calculus accordingly, by placing it on a belief interval and referring to our personal subjective belief system to determine how much we should respond to the likelihood; we don't ever respond to a likelihood with no response, after all. Following on the tail of that argument, there is the consideration of mental transmission of thought, which while certainly fringe fringe thinking, is not uncommon in certain sects of literature, and must equally be incorporated into the mental calculus according to the degree to which the individual believes they could be monitored cognitively (and potentially judged therefore). While the optimization of thought may appear to be the least of our concerns, as the length of this paragraph may demonstrate, it is the most slippery of the fields of effects due to its poorly defined nature, and the nascent status of the field investigating this most tantalizing of phenomena (I haven't even gone into the effects on morphic fields here).

Resources are limited and we must each decide for ourselves which of our battles are worth committing ourselves to, and which of our battles we have the material to be able to wage without great apprehension. At any given moment we are making ripples in at least three fields of effect, with implications far and beyond our ken, but still to be optimized for according to the best of our models, with the most earnest of efforts, at any given time. When we pick up the fallen, when we kiss those we love, when we correctly categorize our recycling, there are moments where we can impact reality through the physical. When we speak with our friends, when we write down our experiences, when we sing out our joy, there are moments when we can impact reality through the linguistic. When we go to bed at night, when we walk in the street, when we attend our workplaces, there are moments where we can hone our reality through the cognitive.

'Effective Affect' Your ex kisses their new partner, but you can't do anything about it because you both agreed that you would remain friends for the sake of your child, so you must maintain your composure, and focus on how you should feel happy for them, because look how they're both smiling. We can be rationally happy for someone, while inside our emotions scream that the situation is unacceptable and requires either immediate rectification, or at minimum a stiff drink (maybe six). There exists a school of thought which dichotomizes between cognitive inclinations, or logic, and emotional impulses, but is this a productive dichotomy, or might a more integrated and less oppositional framework pay

greater productive dividends if adopted? If we could control our emotions perfectly, we would be able to leverage the instinctive cognitive affect to further our development without needing to apply conscious effort to analyzing a situation, due to the subconscious nature of affect. Far from being at odds against each other, emotional affect and logic are two mechanisms which operate on the same system, just according to very slightly impetuses, both of which can be modified through consistent effort applied to introspection.

Emotions are responses to established scenarios and phenomena, sourced from our prior experience both longitudinally through genetics, and more immediately through our personal experiences. The reason we fear spiders is not that spiders cause a lot of harm to us here and now, its instead because we have been conditioned over millions of years to recognize this creature as a threat, despite its relative innocuousness, often bordering on the downright helpful in our homes. Likewise, the reason we feel heartbroken following certain breakups is that we have learned over the previous period of time we've spent with the individual in question, that exposure to them is pleasurable, and the removal of such a stimulus results in a feeling of loss, which is genetically programmed to hurt, thereby discouraging losses. These responses are programmed into us subconsciously, and surface unbidden, as we cannot tell joy to manifest itself in a moment with much efficacy, nor can we dispel depression with a whim, but just because we are unable to affect our affect with much success or immediacy, this does not mean we cannot affect our affect whatsoever. While emotions are biologically programmed and instinctive responses to situational contexts, these instinctive responses can be trained into different operabilities by diligent thinkers.

When we notice that our emotions are maladaptive, we accordingly wish to modify their range and responsiveness, which is done by selecting attention topics, or changing the focus of our thinking and emphasizing different aspects of situations. By emphasizing an optimistic interpretation of events, for instance, we train ourselves to automatically see the benefits of a situation, such as when spiders eat flies, or when breakups lead to new and better connections. This can dull some of the sting of the necessary growing pains we must struggle through, as everyone must learn to endure forms of rejection, and forms of invisibility, the only reasonable response to which is to diminish the efficacy of the instincts pushing us towards fear of rejection or invisibility, due to their taking up valuable cognitive resources, all while suggesting maladaptive responses. When selecting for affective responses we should bear in mind that we are not degenerates looking for our next immediate high, we are systems thinkers trying to develop positive responses in the longest possible term, and must forego considerable pleasure upfront to insure against its dissipation down the line, which means we don't just always reach for happiness, as feeling happy when we should grieve is as maladaptive as grieving joy. So, we can change our emotions; we should change our emotions, but what should we change our emotions to do exactly, operating under the assumption that we are trying to maximize ken?

Affect should be calibrated to smooth pain and pleasure to manageable levels which do not interfere with productivity, and to be adapted to contemporary contexts of the practitioner, who may find the world they inhabit looks very little like the world which their ancestors inhabited. While there are many risks associated with emoting, perhaps the most regularly encountered are that the emotions become overly-consuming, preventing adherence to regimens of development, distracting either by pleasure or pain, from the task at hand. It may be that the hardware system that you run on, your genetics if you are human, was designed for other environments than the one you presently inhabit, in which case you will need to consider what responses you need to prune, and which you should focus on, thereby feeding into and encouraging the growth of. By developing your dialogue with your DNA and encouraging your subconscious and more genetically active system to incorporate your conscious understanding of the world, you not only augment your capacity to effectively emote, but also enhance the transmission of ken between semantic strata in your internal cognitive system, stretching from the genetic to the psychological via the subconscious. Emotions, when trained and trimmed, are our friends, and not something to be ignored, but something to be engaged with as much commitment as we devote ourselves to our other mindful investigations.

Your kid smiles up at you, and you squeeze their hand, because it's ok if your ex is with someone new, you can see how good they work together, and besides, you're talking to someone too; you want to save your focus for them. We can and should train our emotions to minimize maladaptive responses, selecting for the more effective affective states by directing our focus and introspection towards more desired internal states. Far from logic and emotions being at odds with each other, they are two intertwined components which are ultimately trying to get us to learn more, as everything inside us is, and we will attain this goal all the quicker if we prune our responses in response to current actual conditions in our environs. A subconscious quick-twitch cognitive response, previously programmed and available on short notice, is all an emotion is, which is to call it a more quickly activated but lesser considered thought. As our contexts change, so too must our system of engaging with the context, and we can't spend the rest of time pining for people who are better off without us.

'Onuses Upon Ken Economy Participants' Perhaps you have been so kind as to willingly suspend your disbelief, however momentarily, and are being generous enough to consider what an economy based on ken might resemble; you might even go so far as to consider how you might effect change in such a system, and what considerations would be most pertinent to collective, as well as personal development. Bearing all this in mind, there are a number of best practices which present themselves upon further reflection on the implications of such an economic arrangement, alongside my two cents as to what I would consider most pertinent were such a system's presence to be acknowledged. We will not be able to radically shatter the current dominant political system, but what behooves us is to apply concerted effort to improving the system via the fundamental good of transparency, in order that we can begin to examine the extent of

the rot currently extant in the system we've cobbled together, which is based on approximately as solid a foundation as enabling and restricting action by irrational authoritarian fiat, sometimes based on a magic book from yore (if you're lucky). Proceeding with it being understood that change is not effected overnight, and that this is understood to be a gradual process, adherence to a few guiding principles will nevertheless potentially ease friction as we transition into being a more semantically concerned species. The major dimensions to bear in mind when considering one's impacts on a ken based economy are that we actively augment our intellectual capacities, engage in prosocial manners with media, and contribute back to the system in an effective manner.

The first and most important consideration is that of self-improvement; how do we actively augment ourselves intellectually, in order that we can benefit both as a group and individually from the material provided? We are taught to think in schools, which, as of right now, encourage rote-memorization and regurgitation cycles over brief periods, minimally reinforcing through scaffolded learning due to the financial difficulty of personally engaging with students' growth path. I do not mean to lay onus on teachers, who are responsible for a frankly appalling number of students each due to insufficient funding through a society that values lawyers battling to edify corporate power in upscale high-rises ahead of educators directly leading the growth of often upwards of thirty students at a time in downtrodden neighbourhoods, but is instead a polite suggestion that sometimes the more difficult approach returns greater dividends, and that perhaps were we to value education just a little more we might not worry so much about a system predicated on individual belief. Besides the educational system, which people ought to support the enhanced application of resources to, there is also the onus on every individual to improve themselves actively during unstructured spare time, not succumbing to the seduction of easily digested media confirming our biases (I find social media, television, and video games particularly destructive in terms of productivity). These are some best practices for encouraging the cognitive growth of a collective, but if we adhere to these guidelines and educate ourselves in our spare time, all the while being sure to balance this with our need for rest so not over-applying pressure, what media is best consumed to direct our thinking remains unclear.

Clarity regarding media's ideal topics is an age-old question, but is becoming all the more pertinent in an age where everything from ancient platonic texts to cat videos are available at a mere few finger-taps. Try not to consume media which supports a frame of mind you disagree with without sufficient cynicism in place, but simultaneously do not consume only media that you agree with, instead entertaining each's points in mind at any given time while navigating relevant contexts, thereby preventing both risks of echo chambers developing, and that of societies atomizing. Do not analyze impact and value based on volunteered engagement entirely, also account for temporal considerations (how long a user spends with media, even if they don't explicitly indicate their engagement), as while the metrics associated with online engagement regarding the scoreboards of appreciation are effective in their simplicity, there exists a simpler option

which does not depend on individuals' actively engaging, namely valuing content based on time spent with it, and which prevents individuals consuming media without contributing to its growth. Where the option for active engagement exists, take it for works which particularly stir you, regardless of how it might appear to others around you, due to this encouraging creators of more niche subcommunities to maintain their production, and which will have as a correlate the effect of making others more likely to be vocal about their appreciation generally. Once we have consumed a sufficient degree of high-quality media, we cannot help but become engaged in the notion of producing it ourselves, thereby contributing back to the system, and also coming to understand the media which was so compelling for us all the better.

While providing resources back to the system, there are a number of best-practices which can be applied to ensure the most effective application of our efforts, whether or not they are initially taken for anything worthwhile. It's best to contribute to systems which contribute back, not only focusing on the systems which have the lowest cost of entry or obtaining of returns, but also calibrating our considerations for further downstream knock-on effects, including where our resources will go by second and third degrees, which is why boycotting is effective. It's best to accept that our initial attempts at obtaining returns on our resources will be poor, with us likely to lose out by the efforts on paper if we do not account for our learning in the calculations, as is shown when a novice produces a painting, or someone poorly versed in wine attempts to supply a soiree, but if we account for our learning this is a necessary teething period to be endured, albeit in a select range of fields to avoid the risk of overgeneralization. The main of the effort should obviously be applied towards a synthesis of your self, texts, and contexts, to obtain new information through novel and pertinent perspective on irritants and opportunities, which if generously distributed will contribute to the system and ripple back towards you, albeit diluted. If we are able to do this, then there is another corollary effect which bears mentioning, a normalization of free distribution of resources according to accurately identified deficits in the system, which provides a greater collective pot on which to draw.

There is no need to be building schools while listening to audiobooks in your spare time, but I for one would appreciate it if those in our society would more consciously apportion their mental faculties and productive capacities to the benefit of the wider goal of ken generation. By gradually honing our ability to contribute to and engage with ken economies, we will propel the generation of new understanding of our circumstances, improving our adaptation for the situation at hand. By constantly seeking to educate ourselves and our associates, consuming a sensible mix of media, and contributing as we earnestly can back to the system, we improve the system, and ourselves. If you have been waiting for a cue to reengage your disbelief, I encourage you now to do so, and to see how frequently your thinking returns to this topic unbidden, as a proxy metric for the contribution this makes to your local ken. Perhaps we would fear a fiat based system just a little less if we could trust the mob to be a little less reactive, and just ever so slightly more principled; here are some principles, should that

sound appealing.

‘Inebriant Calibration’ I’ve seen my fair share of overdoses, experiencing a few benzodiazepine ones firsthand—one time, in a narcotic den on the Downtown Eastside, I helped to administer four shots of naloxone to a man who’d been matching me puff for puff on the pipe and was consequently not breathing, but the naloxone was to no avail, and I left, (entirely sober I might add, as is the way with me and opiates), when the medics arrived. This is the horror story of inebriant application, but it is not the only one; at this very moment a jaguar is likely tripping in a tree, a wood-pigeon is wankered on rotten fruit, and I have the sneaking suspicion that somewhere deep in the depths of the ocean there is a dolphin dining on dream fish to dimension-hop. The dominant narrative proposes these are anadevelopmental occurrences, and that, in all cases save the one where someone who read books on the substances for a few years and uses the substances to overcome a negative predilection in the subject, there is no cause do use inebriants, which are always, always, extremely naughty and to be avoided like anathema. I will quietly remind the reader that an individual’s productivity at creative tasks is marginally improved when alcohol is consumed within a platilocks range, which would seem to suggest that the consumption of certain substances can propel creative works further than they might be propelled independent of the usage. While there are salient issues with engaging with inebriants, nevertheless it behooves us to expand our thinking and productive capacity in the ken economy, and there are best practices for engaging with such substances, should the reader prove curious.

As ken is the ultimate resource, the organ and underlying mechanisms which process ken most actively should be experimented with, not in a reckless manner, and always being cognizant of the seductive slipperiness that inebriants demonstrate. As has previously been established in my framework, ken (shorter than ‘information’ fewer connotations than ‘knowledge’) is the ultimate resource and goal in both economic markets and spiritual terms, the value of which cannot be overstated. Accordingly, the organ which we analyze ken with most concerted should be strengthened, not merely with regard to rote processing power, but also in terms of resilience to alteration and homeostatic drive, both of which goals inebriants can further if a hormetic approach to hallucination and intoxication is applied. The risk of this is the seductive slipperiness of inebriants, which almost uniformly insist upon their reuptake very shortly after comedown, despite this being a very bad idea (law of diminishing returns) and which cause more euphoria in the short term than they provide in the long term, which can cause unhealthy abuse cycles if left unchecked. While there are risks associated with such experimentation, there are also risks associated with failing to invest in research and development of the mind, which generates the sublime experience (at least when adequately medicated) of consciousness.

Consciousness is the most poorly understood phenomenon that currently has a name, and arguably the most effective to boot. Our ken stems from our conscious experience of the world, which is akin to the filter through which

we view reality, and mightn't it be better to develop a stronger lens through which to view our surroundings? There are very few substances we know of which have direct implications for our consciousness, and those substances which do demonstrate this are better respected as dangerous if used at random, but engaged with as active if used considerately, always bearing in mind that they will diminish consideration as their first effect, so be careful. If consciousness were graphed, we would be chock-a-block with data points in the sobriety range, while the range associated with inebriation is relatively less populated with data, which results in inebriants contributing more to the trend line than sobriety, and trend lines are easier to compress and store in semantic systems than data points individually are. Inebriation is dangerous if leapt into, but with a tempered approach, a cognitively stable position of outset, resilient social support network, and a mental health system which supports user rather than villainizing them, we might be able to optimize more of our biological systems to process ken.

Due to the high valence of possibility for personal growth through chemical engagement in a ken-based system, it behooves individuals to experiment to determine which substances are most conducive to and supportive of their goals, as well as being more cogniscent of active users' needs. There are some best practices suggested, including finding what works for your individual biochemical system, and in the process of determining this remaining hypervigilant to the seductive slipperiness of the substances and their potential negative effects—if in doubt, use less. When around those using substances, do not under any circumstances impose punishment for usage, as this will result in concealment and the fracturing of trust; instead, it is better to encourage the individual to keep you abreast of their usage patterns, and regularly check in to inquire if you can support them at all. It is tempting to assume we know more than someone because we rigidly adhere to the status quo, just like everyone else around us, and it is easy to assume we know best about something because there are people who agree with us, but if we can't explain mechanisms of action, are we understanding, or reacting? Due to the possibilities we are opened to through the consumption of inebriants, we would be better served by engaging with them as a legitimate topic of discourse, rather than an ugly mystery to be swept under the proverbial rug, or a cudgel to be used to bludgeon those who stray from standard operation procedures.

The momentarily deceased man, who I recall being about six-foot-five, a barrel-chested indigenous fellow with the Louis Vuitton symbol tattooed on his face in red, supposedly lived (I found out by calling the drug den the next day) but I never saw him again, which is for the best as some people, not necessarily through any fault of their own, can bring out our bad sides. I am not proud of my overdoses, or any of my failures when investigating the phenomenon of consciousness chemically, but the alternative would be worse; I could be financially successful and plugged into the collective mirage that the world is trying to run on. The thing about the jaguar, wood pigeon, and dolphin, is that these are proadaptive evolutionary strategies which are resilient to selection pressures against them, and that tells us almost all we need to know about the matter. I

propose that what makes poison poisonous is not simply its presence, but that the virulence of a substance is instead determined by potency, receptors, and structure of the chemical in question, which three factors, if balanced appropriately, might just help us see the world a little more clearly, no matter how much it's breathing.

'The Primacy of Self in Prosocial Behaviour' Why do I advocate for contributions to the whole, when it is clear that by embracing a more financialized and extractive manner I might leverage my evident gifts to establish a more stable and traditionally successful existence? While it may appear as if I am a bleeding heart who just wants to help everyone else out and sacrifice himself into a messy martyrdom, I must assert my cold, calculating, and ultimately supreme self-interest. The truth is that I am contiguous with the entities at closest hand, and those at several degrees of removal, and rather than petulantly puffing my chest out and pretending there is such a thing as an island, I am entirely convinced that I am a member of a network, a node if you will, a cell in the cosmic body. This viewpoint is perhaps marginally more radical than initial consideration may reveal, as the foundation of much of contemporary capitalist theory rests upon the supposition that personal greed and a desire to take as shamelessly as possible are beneficial for the whole of the network. This essay demonstrates that taking from people without giving back not only removes from the rightful repositories the value which ought to be diversely spread, but also results in a system which is predicated on predation rather than mutualism.

We cannot experience motivation for anything outside of our experience, we are, accordingly, fundamentally self-interested, as even when we give to others, as the only reason we can possibly give is that it feels good—for us, the only people whose internal state we are privy to. The only means we have for determining our desires is our internal signalling, and any attempts to prove otherwise must first prove a telepathic connection between the person claiming to be able to experience things for someone else, and the someone else apparently able to be experienced. Even when acting for others, this is due to our internal signalling saying that we should, not due to some intangible goodness which we are driven by, angelic though we might be. This means we are fundamentally self-interested, but not to such an extent we are unable to contribute to others, just as a soldier, seeking his own survival, may take risks for the good of his platoon. We are all soldiers in the army of creation, and recognizing our integrated status is one of the first obstacles to overcome in order to begin subconsciously balancing how much we take from our surroundings versus how much we give back.

We are individuals in a networked group—there's no such thing as an island, and to assume we can inflict externalities on a system without balancing the scales is the height of willed ignorance. We take from those who give to us, and give to those who take from us, whether we want to or not, and we cannot be self-sufficient, no matter how hard we try (trust me I have done it). This means that we benefit from awareness of the group, which should be understood in the most general terms possible, to prevent competitive loss between groups, as by

embracing a wider swath of creation as kin, we increase the odds of mutually beneficial trades predicated on a shared model of ken. We must understand our rewards to be commensurately based upon our contributions to the group, as we are only provided for so long as we can provide more than the provisions we're given amount to; systems abhor dead weight, despise extractors, and will invariably assault any with the temerity to insinuate that their behaviour is to be emulated rather than dissected to discover the enemy's deficits. This rhetoric is as yet insufficient to address the economic perversity currently in vogue, waltzing about in plain view of us all, daring us to controvert it, which is easily done via analogy.

There are analogues biologically for entities that become self-absorbed and try to replicate absent the wider system's say-so—we call these entities cancerous, and they appear remarkably similar to many professions currently operating on the 'shamelessly-take-all-you-can-get' philosophy, and who really ought to know better, and might be due some reeducation via pecuniary punishment at scale. Using the analogue of a human individual biological system, we might consider ourselves analogous to cells in a body, with the body being society, or creation, depending on the extent of the practitioners achievement of ego-death. Cells which are able to communicate with those around them, and which support the bodily more readily, are those we prefer to support, and those which we use the semantic signature (genes) of for the production of future models. Cells which wantonly take all they can get and replicate without the consent of the larger biological system are considered cancerous, and are excised upon discovery, with huge medical departments concertedly attempting to handle the damage. According to this interpretation of events, we currently have an economically enfranchised segment of society which is metastasizing in the processing center of our societal corps, which is, of course, as it should be.

It is impossible to flatly determine how much you owe the system, and how much the system owes you, but in order to be safe from reproach, which may or may not become a reproach with teeth, it is better for us to provide as much as we can before we begin to whine about our due. We all seem to imagine we've given more than we have, and we all seem to have rationalized why we deserve more than the system gives us, ah, the human condition. Fortunately, I am also of the opinion that we all want to contribute, it is just that certain individuals appear dead-set on the belief that extractive behaviour is to be encouraged and contributes to a more hard-nosed but pragmatic approach to the world. There are cancerous cells, who consume resources and can ultimately end their hosts through their selfishness, and the major faculty these cells have is to claim to the corps that they are in fact contributing members of the body proper. Cancerous individuals are, in fact, parasitic at best, taking from our body without returning a yield on the input resources, and at worst are downright predatory, as I have yet to see any evidence of these individuals slowing their extraction in the face of impending societal collapse; a more aggressive excision strategy may be warranted.

‘Temporal and Probabilistic Organization’ How many parallel universes are there, exactly? The parallel universes theory is a tantalizing introductory notion, but there is, on further reflection and familiarity with the literature, very much a structure to the intermingled dimensions, which are differentiated based on their coordinates on a variety of planes. These different universes can be considered as analogous to individuals or atoms, in that establishing any form of differentiation amongst them must first be prefaced by the differentiator noting the impossibility of entirely separating the parts, and affirming that there are greater variations within the groups than among them, with the boundary around groups not being clearly demarcated, but degree-based and probabilistic. It is taken as read at this stage that the universe consists of the observable physical universe, which has a three dimensional size, measurable in the units of the measurers preference. There are three terms we may addend to and clarify the discourse with: the “probability map”, the “cosmos”, and “L-space” (established by Pratchett), each of which serves to clarify ambitions and capacities in the field of intertemporal navigation.

The probability map is our current position in the universe, and the range of the probabilities which can grow out of it. If we view this in terms of the present moment being a ring, and all the temporal paths possible being fibers or strings passing through that ring, then the area of the ring is the size of the probability map, which we as individuals are on somewhere, and can modify our position in, with effort. Returning to a previous example, then if we are currently in a position where the person cutting us off in traffic is fifty percent not seeing you there, then you might be able to modify your position on the probability map to move the percentage up to a given percentage, but there will be limits to our mobility on the probability map based on our temporal navigation capacity. It’s worth noting that the ring is in the shape of a fibonacci sequence, and the string fibers of timelines are on fire and dancing as they combust, with the fresh futures growing from the fumes. The probability map is a larger space than the mere “present” which standard discourse might tell us we inhabit, but it is nothing near as voluminous as the proceeding strata of organization.

The cosmos is all the probability maps of all the universes according to the laws of the cosmos. Cosmoses are understood to exhibit the aforementioned non-discrete behaviour, and differ from each other according to gradients in their laws, as one cosmos may share its gravity coefficient with another, but differ by its golden ratio, or by the number of tits acceded for a tat in game theory. In the cosmic range there is a timeline where from the big bang to the singularity, the dawn of humanity to humanity’s extinction, from the birth of Christ to the immanentized eschaton, no coin has been flipped without coming down on its edge. A cosmos is imagined as all the possibilities that could have happened, without changing the underlying programming of reality, as in we’d need to keep energy equaling the speed of light squared. There is a final level of organization, however, where energy may be equal to a banana, in all cases ever.

L-space is the range of possible cosmoses which can be conceived of, and can be

considered as the range of all possible timelines. There may be cosmoses which differ according to their underlying mathematical constants and programming, but there are also many different cosmoses which, far from differing by just the Planck constant, have entirely different humour force mechanics than our own. There is a form of cosmic probability map, as well as being the aforementioned universal one, and we may be able to not only modify the likelihood of different universal probabilities according to our metaphysical aptitudes, but also modify the underlying coding of the cosmos we inhabit, if we are cognizant enough to find a firm place to stand, now we have such a lengthy lever. L-space is where the mechanics of narrative become most salient, as this is the arena in which the animism of the soul associated with the grouping is most significant. It is worth noting that there are, just like gradient degrees between cosmoses, gradient degrees between cosmoses and L-spaces as well, and cosmoses with universes to boot.

If the range of parallel universes is defined as including individual moments within universes of cosmoses in their respective L-space(s), then as infinities go, that might be one of the heftier ones. While it can be challenging determining the constituent parts of a metaphysical simulatory system, the first thing to do is to look as widely as possible, before zooming in as closely as possible, as whichever principles are acting in both domains are the most foundational ones. Then, remind yourself that those principles are animized and actively attempting to obtain their goals, just as you are. It goes, I hope by now without saying, that this is but a raver's perspective on esoteric cartography, and must be taken with maximum salt. The probability map is the range of possible timelines you could inhabit in the present moment; the cosmos is the range of probability maps that can be allowed by the cosmic rules in play; L-space is the range of cosmoses when rules become uncoupled.

'Escaping Entropy' Things are getting a little crazy, which physics tells us is the natural order of things. Classical physics proposes that systems tend towards entropic maximization, where chaos ultimately reigns, as cheese sandwiches left unattended and thereby either disappearing or deteriorating, can attest to. Farbeit for me to challenge a cornerstone of physics in a thousand words or less this Monday morning, but it does appear as if living organisms, which are relatively plentiful in our near environs, challenge this principle by organizing themselves from a relatively less organized resource base. I am not saying that the average panther is applying itself directly to the proper means of deriving forty-two as the answer to the ultimate question, but pantheric efforts are contributing to the movement of the universe towards organization and order, completely contrary to the physicists assertions, which are predicated on a minute dataset. Entropy is a fundamental component of a ken-based cosmic system, and should be understood as the anti-ken, conceptual navigation of which may enhance temporal dynamism.

Learning is organization, and as corollary, the drive towards life is the universe moving in an anti-entropic direction, demonstrated with our planet which once

was a hunk of inorganic rock and metal, and is now a teeming pile of organic entities vying for space, due to the lifeforms ability to take random resources and properly organize these into functional conglomerates. While inanimized systems (a useful fiction) tend towards entropy (chaos), animized systems tend towards organization (order), and the more a system lives, the more it will impose its order, according to the semantic signatures it carries, on its surroundings. Ken is the capacity to impose this order on chaos, which life appears to automatically move towards, optimizing for maximum order in the system as maximum order enhances predictability, which ensures the effective allocation of resources. When we learn, we increase the organization of the system, even if only latently in the cognitive sense rather than strictly in terms of physical effects, which is to say that while reading a book on cheese sandwich production does not produce, in of itself, a cheese sandwich, nevertheless it brings the cheese sandwich one step closer, and thus we enhance the organization of the system through potential (like stretching an elastic material, the elastic energy is present but not released, latent when needed). Ken acquisition is an automatic function of life, and may be the major organizing principle.

While there are tendencies systems demonstrate at lower levels, when there is evidence demonstrating that these systems cannot extend findings to wider frames, more inclusive methodologies must be developed. We cannot explain life according to the standard models proposed by physics, which glosses over living systems with an embarrassed clearing of its throat whenever the concept is mentioned in the context of debates about entropy. Learning, ken acquisition, imposition of order, all appear standard physical phenomena and should be integrated using the best metrics we have of knitting the phenomena with extant metrics. This is likely to ruffle feathers, as there is an inertia to developing new ken and moving on the cognitive landscape to a new position, just as there is physical inertia when moving in three dimensional space. If we look at a system up close, sure, it looks like it's getting disorganized over time, but we've only been asking this question for a few hundred years, at most, while the evidence of many millennia seems to suggest that the universe, far from becoming disorganized as time passes, is instead marshalling its resources to organize into the most efficient configuration available, and thank goodness it is doing so, as otherwise cheese sandwiches would be a logical impossibility.

Such findings could eventually result, if disobeying a small local tendency is possible, in disobeying the larger local tendency of time's unidirectional flow, because if we haven't understood the mechanisms of action of a system, it may have capacities we currently do not credit it with. Just as on a small scale we cannot organize a physical system by waiting, and yet clearly at large scales organization does occur automatically and independent of our engagement, we are currently looking at a small system where temporal movement is not possible, but it may be occurring outside that frame of reference. If temporal movement is a possibility, the fact that entropic degrees are associated with temporal shifts, and ken is inherently knit with entropy, may be indicative of ken's importance when moving temporally. In order to determine this, it may be possible to have

a processing system such as a supercomputer be fed large volumes of ken at the most rapid pace possible, with the system clock being tracked very closely for infinitesimal shifts in either direction, with time being understood to be most likely to slow first (this being the most adaptive and simple of the temporal movements to effect). An entropic system wouldn't produce this essay, nor would it produce the context that make this essay necessary; far from moving towards a heat death of the universe as the energetic landscape homogenizes, it is more likely that we are able to continue leveraging energy through increasing order imposed on its flow.

This essay has been an earnest attempt to impose some order on what is currently a crazy academic climate, where we have people whose careers are predicated on arguing that actually things get less developed as time goes on, which missive they spout through state-of-the-art technology, making use of groundbreaking mathematics to aver their fallacy. Cheese sandwiches are natural outgrowths of a ken based temporal flow, which can potentially be engaged with if the underlying mechanics are understood sufficiently through theory, and investigated with critical apparatus. While it may appear as if there are forces extant that seek to undo the organization which we've imposed on our surroundings, panthers seeking our dissolution, we must understand these as lower-level entropies which can be integrated into higher-level ken if properly framed. We cannot always move towards organization, as if the temporal movement were unidirectional we'd already be perfectly organized, and there would be nothing left to learn, but that would be dreadfully dull, so as creation breathes in it engages ken, and out it blows entropy. While entropy is a seductive argument, in that it can be immediately observed at play in the here and now, nevertheless it is best understood as a beginning point from which we move, rather than something that is actively occurring in the ultimate sense.

'Dancing Closely' The attentive reader may, by this stage, be aware that the only thing I prefer to a well-structured five paragraph essay on an unwieldily large topic, is a well-structured dance. Up to this point I have been remiss, in that I have provided advice for the principles of moshery, but moshes are relatively rare beasts, which only occur every few blue blood moons (likely due to the influence of PISH-POSH), and are rarely encountered in the wild. This makes moshes all the more special, and to be treasured commensurately, but how does one build the group comfort necessary to lay the groundwork for eventual moshery, and, absent a full-blown mosh situation being on the cards, how does one engage in close contact dance in a respectful yet liberated manner? Close dancing is defined as dancing whereby two individuals engage in a communal freestyle, and the results of its production are more aesthetically pleasing than an individual freestyle is, due to the relation between the two of them adding a dimension which either's dance in isolation lacks. Dancing closely is another approach to dancing, which provides fertile opportunities for the development of emergent kinetic properties, and which can be built up to through gradual steps.

We close dance when not moshing but also not solo, as greater effects are available if dancing in synchronicity with those around us. This is a practice which can be engaged with in any group freestyle dance setting, the most commonly encountered of which are nightlife venues, so long as the dancer is comfortable enough with their surroundings to be able to begin ingratiating themselves physically on the dance floor. In such spaces it can be difficult connecting with people and generating emergent properties out of the dancing due to the inability to generate the familiarity needed for inhibition loss, which would result in a flow state; we need to break the ice. The communal flow state is the goal of close dance, and the initial ice breaking will come by your overall impression (vibe), and the moves you use, as well as your behaviour in the venue over time (especially important if you frequent specific venues regularly), which will colour the person you're trying to dance with's impression of you. Supposing you've established that close dancing is good, found a person you want to do it with, and have already established your credos by busting quite the move, there remains an approach to make before the close dancing can begin.

As it is not conducive to dancing to speak during the dance (how many times can we yell "what" in each other's ears at point blank range), it is best to react to the individual in question with whom you are trying to synchronize your movements, with an increasing degree of response to their movements depending on the approacher's degree of interest, and the approacher's degree of reciprocation. If attempting to determine goodwill on the part of the dancer with whom you'd dance, a fist-bump may be used to identify whether the approach is appreciated or otherwise, with the bare minimum requirement being a return on your bumping, and if the bump is not returned, move on. Following, or even prior to a successful fist-bump (if you're feeling bold), you may begin mirroring their movements, or reacting to the other person's movements with your own movements, as there are many subpatterns in music that can be picked up on, and attention to the person in question may reveal which subpattern they are responding to, allowing you to follow it as well. This can be disconcerting for the person being mirrored, and their comfort is your utmost priority if you are approaching them in this manner, so you must at all stages be hyperaware of their signalling both verbal and nonverbal; if your approach is not requited, immediately back off and provide space to the person. Assuming the fist-bump goes to plan, and the mirroring results in some mirth but overall doesn't seem to be causing too much trouble, and hopefully by this point having caught their eye regularly as well to facilitate facial recognition of any reluctance, you may now begin to get close.

Once a synchronization has been achieved, it becomes a matter of maximizing bodily contact, while simultaneously maintaining high fidelity responses to the music being played, which two goals the tension between will generate the beauty of the movement through their navigation. When it is entirely evident, beyond a shadow of a doubt, that the individual appreciates your engaging with their movements by integrating your own into their patterning, then you may begin to establish physical contact immensely gradually. This would ideally be-

gin with quick moments of contact, established by predicting where their body will be momentarily paused in a movement, and establishing contact at this time, while being careful to arrange contact between non-erogenous zones prior to establishing more erogenous contact (if that is the end goal), although the opposite approach, establishing contact where their body is moving least and so you are more sure of making contact properly, is also acceptable, so long as it is a respectable and tentative moment of contact. Having tested the waters, and finding them consensually welcoming, bodies may be moved as closely together as both parties are comfortable with, with the understanding that the more area of contact between your bodies the more difficult it is to dance properly, which is where the fun comes in. Eventually you may find yourself grinding with the other person, which is fun for about thirty seconds until you realize it has taken all of the flavour out of your dancing, and at which stage you may discover that there is an interesting tension between your desire for physical proximity, and your desire for flow.

Close dancing must be approached with the utmost caution, as if we leap into physical contact we run the risk of violating the laws of consent, and rendering the dance floor an inhospitable space, which would be to all our detriment. There are many manners of approaching people and getting into their space in order to be able to dance with them, and ultimately you should do what feels correct for you, so long as you do this without harming others in the process. If you do find yourself in such a situation as wanting to dance with people around you, then I hope you'll consider trying to apply these principles and seeing what comes of it. Moshes are great, and we should dance for our own feeling of elation, in the most visceral manner possible, but a part of our enjoyment comes from the social component of dance, which is a difficult component to engage now that none of us know the steps for partner dances, which are stuffy at the best of times anyway. If someone should approach you, it is tempting to dismiss them, but perhaps we might find that by accepting the approaches of a wider range of individuals, and being more open to new directions when dancing, a certain joy emerges.

'Importance of Recursion' Five paragraph essays are, as has been established through rigorous prior scholarship, a sanctified ken format, capable of communicating profound truths through relatively simplistic sentence structuring interwoven with paragraph formats, all according to strong formulaic logical relationships. The larger lesson imparted here, however, is not that the five paragraph is especially special in of itself, but rather that recursion as a property of reality is an underappreciated phenomenon, with significant structural implications for individuals sensitive to temporal shift via synchronicity. Due to the simulated nature of reality, as a recursive device, or form of snake eating its own tail in a sublatory manner, investigation of the principle of recursion itself is likely to communicate synonymous truths. By writing five paragraph essays about five paragraph essays the writer will develop not only a head for the philosophical vertigo, which asset may come in handy once peering down the claded timelines of a cosmic narrative tree, but also a greater awareness

of the five paragraph essay's communicative best-practices. Recursion is able to support stronger communication goals via a medium and provides insights into the simulation's programming; an awareness of it may ultimately provide further capacity for narrative selection or temporal navigation.

Recursion allows the most sophisticated analyses of the format being practiced, as a producer must understand very well their materials to be able to represent them outside their own frame. By experimenting with framing conventions, and liminal cases, the practitioner develops more sophisticated awareness of the medium in question, with a range of spectacularly different effects obtainable via different mediums, and different meta considerations in each format, but underlying each an attempt to push the boundary using no new information, just the format in front of one. The most interesting areas of development in any given field are in fringe areas, which are generated either by knitting disparate disciplines, or by folding a discipline back on itself to apply it to itself. When these new and unexpected combinations are (five paragraph) essayed, there is ken generated by the contrast between modalities, and the recursive effect, which often provides contrast, but can also provide symmetry of a kind, or opposition, even, under certain circumstances. While the effects of recursive work in any particular discipline may range wildly depending on the medium in question, nevertheless by applying systems to themselves emergent properties entirely different from the underlying structures may be produced.

Speaking of media, those are each simulations, representations, of our reality, and all we are is a slightly higher resolution simulation further up the ladder of simulating, which is itself a recursive structure. Just like how our simulations are lower resolution versions of our reality, higher level simulations are higher resolution realities, likely more complex than our own, likely used for similar purposes, because analogous functions breed analogous structures, up to a point, and above is as below, up to a point. In the same way that we simulate in order to learn or entertain, so too do the simulators of our level on the reality system. The question then becomes how much agency we have in an imposed plot line that may be optimizing for pratfalls which we don't find particularly funny. The choice of entertainment which is being consumed, and the format of ken provided by the subject in the simulation, may be responsive to pressures applicable by the subject, and recursive ken aids us in applying such pressures.

Given that we are imperfect fractals, whereby the simulated entertainment we consume is the simulated entertainment we thereby generate, it behooves us to select for entertainment value and ken that we want to be idols of ourselves. We are one step on a ladder, with higher resolution simulations above us, and lower resolution simulations beneath us, and the steps in that ladder exert a pressure on each other to maintain a certain unity. What we consume in simulation format, from oral story, to diagram on a piece of paper, to reality television, or video game, influences the form of simulation we are in ourselves. We must accordingly balance between two competing needs; we must simultaneously faithfully simulate our reality to a high degree of fidelity, and also select for the

ideal simulation we would like to inhabit—the interplay between empirical and normative here in dynamic conflict. By consciously thinking about what kind of narratives we espouse, and what forms of entertainment we consider moral or ethical, we will improve our own treatment at the hands of forces stronger than us higher up the simulation ladder.

A five paragraph essay is a highly satisfying object, but all the more so when it is a five paragraph essay on the topic of five paragraph essays, or at least one that uses them as a running example. Recursive thinking is a representation of the simulation’s recursion; we may be able to modify the narrative forces in play at the level of L-space, and thereby the probabilities of our cosmic timeline, by being aware of such recursive properties. While there can be no confirmation that this is the case, the engine of this system is analogy, or metaphor, if you will, as idols are always imbued with the spirit of their representations, and if it looks like a duck in one context, and you see a duck elsewhere, it may imply a similarities to the contexts. Reality is a simulation because we simulate, and it is recursive because we recurse. The ideal five paragraph essay may take as its main topic its own navel, and in looking so closely find a bird’s eye view on the whole corpus.

‘Dance Tips’ Feeling the dance is great, but there must be best practices for how to feel the dance according to those who apparently do so, and who apparently practice dancing for some godforsaken amount of time per day, and who can systematize creation on a Monday morning armed with a teenage essay format. Well, perceptive and slightly persnickety reader, I am pleased you provided me this opportunity to once more wade into a morass which I’ve received absolutely no institutional exposure to, and thereby expand the homegrown boogie pedagogy of one cosmic raver. So settle into a spot somewhere near stage left, find your zone and begin experimenting with movement as concertedly as you will, but perhaps bear these tips in mind when expressing yourself kinetically. I have done my utmost darnedest to codify my gradated approach to dance as an ascending sequence of commitment to the music with physical response. Dance is notoriously difficult to systematize, but that’s not hindered me yet, and I see no reason to develop a restrictive sense of humility at this late stage in the simulation.

When not immediately gripped by a sweeping need to leap onto the floor and immediately giving everything to the full-body—head-bang, the development of smaller movements including finger-tapping and head-nodding is a low-barrier to beginning to contribute to the collective scene. Beginning with the smallest movement you are comfortable with, such as tapping fingers on a leg or nodding your head gently, begin to familiarize yourself with the general tone of the soundscape, becoming familiar with the style being played, and settling into the social space of the venue at hand. The small movements should be gradually intensified according to your capacity to contribute to the communal scene evolving in front of you; apply effort to the contribution, but don’t break a sweat yet. When you begin to feel the movements spreading naturally, such

as by your whole head rolling with a nod, or rather more of your arm wanting to join the fingers than you'd consciously bargained for, it's time to move to the next step. This ideally occurs organically, with a transitional smoothness that does not see these stages as entirely separate, but contiguous, and here artificially demarcated for ease of comprehension.

When you feel comfortable and want to move more, transition to moving larger areas, with hips (swaying) or shoulders (bobbing) two standard regions that can be activated in the middle stage, traditionally gendered as male for the shoulders and female for the hips (but hey do whatever gets you in the zone best). Hips may be emphasized more or less in the sway as compared with the wider body, rendering more lascivious movements as hips are isolated, if the goal is to render such coy displays, which would ideally be done within a tasteful range given the circumstances (best not to gyrate too pronouncedly at a child's birthday). Shoulders provide, as they are separate in a manner hips are not, the opportunity for synchronization or productive juxtaposition of movement, generating a more harmonized or more chaotic aesthetic in either case. There are other zones which can be activated first, such as going straight to bobbing on the toes, which while this author does not prefer personally as a graded approach to engaging the whole body, he is open to the application of such, and would far rather someone do anything with their body rather than making like PISH-POSH and constantly complaining about the music. Assuming you make it to this stage, and yet are still not satisfied, a plight I am entirely sympathetic to, and encourage the sense of, then further activation of physical regions may be harmonized into the whole.

The final step is to shift balance primarily onto the toes, and begin by bouncing on the toes to the beat as the other body parts maintain their rhythms, culminating in swinging the body as a whole in synchronization to the impressions provided by a given tune. When you're ready to really begin committing to the current of sound, shift onto your toes to provide yourself the ability to react quickly to musical signals with the whole body's following the signal, and begin bouncing on your toes to the beat, integrating the movement with the extant rhythms already being physically applied. Begin to magnify the movements, committing more energy into the meeting of beats with crisp moves, hitting each wobble of the drop or twang of the strum with more panache than the last one. Synchronize various body parts in various manners, experimenting freely and determining what feels best for the given musical context, and have as much fun as you possibly can do, while ensuring that your range and vociferousness of movement does not detract from the rights of others to enjoy the music sans obnoxious obliviousness to the impression a person can leave when dancing utterly without filter. While there is a risk associated with committing too concertedly to the dance, and becoming more lively than might be entirely socially advisable, it pales in comparison to the risk of being sidelined by your anxiety, and thereby missing out on the opportunity to really groove properly.

This is a graded approach to dancing by activating physical regions in a cas-

cade of commitment to the kinetic expression, depending on the individual's comfort and willingness to express themselves in the given context. I cannot promise you that you will not look silly, nor do I believe silliness should be avoided in the field of dance nearly as much as it appears to be; we are all earnestly engaged in taking ourselves far too ruddy seriously. By beginning with small movements, which can be magnified by the dancer depending on their degree of comfort and interest in contributing to the communal scene, a dancer lays the groundwork for later, more expressive movements. It can often be intimidating beginning to dance in certain contexts, especially if these are unfamiliar, or the dancer has been brave enough to venture out solo to attain a dance (more power and the utmost respect to those as do this). If you're not sure where to begin, or how to scale up from the more non-committal of the movements, then please give this a shot, and remember to gyrate tastefully, but please, do gyrate away.

'Aesthetic Theory' Aesthetics are the study of appearance, and the intersection of this surface appearance with its underlying deeper meaning, or the relation between symbol and signified; surprise surprise, it's all a metaphor. Whether in text, through the composition of works in which symbol and theory collide; or on a canvas, where colours cross with countenances; or in an outfit, where the registers of formality and fun might be found to cross-pollinate, aesthetic is foundationally important for our analysis of beauty, and thereby joy. I have done my best to determine what principles I tend to apply when determining my own aesthetic judgments in a variety of domains, and present them here in the most general terms possible, leaving open the option to delve more deeply into a sub-discipline at a later date if it becomes compelling. At the end of the day, of course, you should express yourself however you are most comfortable expressing, but if you're interested in a system of aesthetics, then here's how I approach the discipline. The core considerations for aestheticization are balance and its subversion, range of feature, and recursive statement.

The most important consideration aesthetically is balancing juxtaposition and synchronization, harmonization and subversion, with the ultimate goal of high-lighting harmony. There are numerous features which can be balanced, including chromacy (red versus blue), shade (dark versus light), drape (form-fitting versus loose), texture (sleek versus bobby), diction (high versus low), etc. It is seen as poor style to have too much of any one thing, instead these various factors must be both juxtaposed and synchronized, harmonized and subverted. The ultimate goal is coherence of style, which is achieved, counterintuitively, by subverting a certain amount of coherence to juxtapose and thereby emphasize the overarching harmony. While dancing through the harmonization and subversion of harmony, it may become apparent that not all disciplines can be engaged with equally, or in some cases, at all.

We must be careful to select a specialized range of styles and techniques, as everything is nothing, and it is the restraint of our liberty which prevents us homogeneously taking up everything available, us each. It is important to deter-

mine what range of icons and schools you will apply to the aesthetic in question, and while not dogmatically remaining tied only to these, instead using them as focal points for the aesthetic. Overabundance of material results in lack of rails to productively constrain development, as you will not be able to master all aesthetic arts, and will instead become a dilettante in a wide range of fields, able to emulate the discourse, but fundamentally divorced from the decisive debates pertinent to a medium. Accordingly, find approaches or looser methodologies to specialize in the integration of, balancing specialization and generalization, and determining where there is a legitimate need for aesthetes to work. Having selected a platilocks range of symbols or media factors to engage with, the quest for aesthetic becomes a matter of acknowledging interlinked aesthetic strata.

By remembering the importance of recursion, thereby having ramifications between different strata of aesthetic combination, the aesthete knits their aesthetic across the various levels. It's not just about having symbols on the same strata mirror or subvert each other, there should be representations of analogous structures present at different levels, which is to say if your clothing is nice, or your punctuation neat, then your jewelry ought to be similarly appreciable, and your phrasing harmonically tame (unless subverting in that instance). The simplest recursion is between literal and metaphorical, with the symbol ideally harmonizing or subverting the expectation implicit within it, and by becoming familiar with a wider range of symbolic correspondences, the aesthete develops greater range of engagement with media. At all stages, consider the medium of aestheticization, which will be the penultimate grounding for recursion before it recurs with reality more generally, the medium being most directly expressed in is the primary concern when expressing. Recursion is an important feature of creation, and may be the backbone of aesthetic theory, as it is the backbone of much else.

Aesthetics are a field synonymous with a shallow vapid approach to reality, emphasizing only physical attractiveness, rather than the whole suite of beauty accessible to a concerted seeker. While the term may have been poisoned somewhat by the proliferation of nail salons and the fetishization of surfaces as the foundations of decency crumble, nevertheless the underlying desire for beauty is noble, and to be supported. Many appear to consider aestheticization as similar to affect: interminably ineffable, and all the better for its mystery, but I'd aver that investigation of something confirms its value, and am committed to digging further into finery's forms. While beauty remains ensconced most firmly in the eyes of the beholder, this beholder has found that certain patterns compound and augment the aspiring aesthete, while certain predilections and ignorances can hold such a one back. Beauty is negotiable, but we need a shared jargon to communicate about it effectively, here's a term or two, should they prove to be of use.

'Fashion Theory' There is very little I find more fetching than someone who has dressed themselves with full awareness of the implications of their dress, and clearly harmonized a unified look, and then provided it so kindly for general ap-

preciation out and about. There have even been times when, with a great sense of sheepishness, I have asked strangers to pose for photos so that I could record their aesthetics. A part of the reason for this is the established and significant framework of ‘as above, so below’, which to me suggests that individuals ought to seek to express their underlying faculties and characteristics as faithfully as they’re able via dress. The other part of the reason is that I admire beauty, and seek it as often as I am able, both doing my best to produce it for others, and to appreciate that produced by others. Fashion may be seen as a low, consumerist art form, but it has merits which ought not to be dressed down by such interpretations; for those interested in learning more, here are a few considerations when determining dress.

The primary concern of any analysis of fashion must begin with material, rather than brand, which may be controversial at your local mall. Materials should be selected for their functional values, their degree of comfort, ability to dry, stretch, drape over body, etc., ideally without selling out to the dominant orthodoxy of polyester everything, as the functional impact of that is enhanced plastic production and toxic microfibers in our waterways. We ought to select our materials for the connotations that they impart, with heavier fabrics like ducks or denims suggesting a more weathered, hardy individual, and lighter materials like poplins or seersuckers suggesting more refinement, and sensitivity. There is also the meaning of the material to consider, as polyester means you’re either going to exercise very rigorously, or you’ve selected the wrong garment for the occasion, while recycled wool means you’re not only ecologically conscious, but also savvy about long-term wear on materials. Having established a desired range of materials, and beginning to determine the weave of those materials, weave blends from material into pattern, which is the next consideration.

The pattern of the items in use should ideally be restricted and harmonized, to prevent the wearer from appearing askew and adrift, at a loss on the sea of aesthetic options. It is a cardinal sin to dress overly involvedly, with the understanding that some exuberance is warranted, but that more often than not people make the mistake, when trying to dress expressively, of wearing overly much rather than too little; however, the opposite can also be an issue, as there is nothing worse than someone who mistakes a permanent all-plain-black uniform with class (it’s not class—it’s aesthetic slovenliness, which the rest of us must suffer through in monochromatic agony). There should be an accepted palette of patterns which the dresser uses, depending on the degree of their community’s acceptance of flair, which is to say that if you live in Canada, it is seen as untoward to wear double plaids, while in other cultures clashing patterns can be expected, and this shows the cultural flexibility around the notion of sartorial taste. Once you’ve selected a desired palette of patterns (for instance: I use stripes often, herringbones often, and avoid all other patterns besides the irrevocable motley), then you are ready to begin applying them at the pertinent levels, as one does not apply more than one visual image across the strata of look, which means that a tattoo on your forearm makes your tee graphic tasteless (but it already was due to excessive conformance, if it was

smack-bang in the middle of your chest). Having established what patterns click for you, and determining where each can be applied, there is the final consideration of different major schools of dress to be engaged with.

There are a variety of common aesthetic archetypes at this time which can be identified, and which familiarity with can provide greater capacity to the would-be aesthete. Formal silhouettes are those favoured by white-collar professionals, and associated styles, typified by an emphasized collar (often with tie), more lightweight natural materials, and are associated with credentials and respect, but also run the risk of stuffiness or pompousness being conveyed. At the opposite end of the spectrum is athletic wear, spearheaded by various sports teams internationally, and a society that seems to prefer we pretend to be ever-active than earnestly accept that we can't always be in the gym; this look usually minimizes collars, with hoods present instead, and with bright, loud colours on synthetic materials, which associates this look with relaxation and casualness, but which runs the risk of appearing unnecessarily prepared or just utterly unimaginative and clinging to the cultural moment with all the self-awareness of a lemming in flight. We proceed to a midway point, workwear, which is typified by durable materials, consisting of both natural (cotton) and synthetic materials, in a variety of silhouettes straddling athletic and formalwear, depending on the functional need of the field in question, and subscribers to the workwear look may attain an air of sober rationality, but run the risk of being identified as not needing the hammer loop after all. These are the major archetypes of dress at this time, with the added caveat that these emphasize male styles, as if I were to begin writing about how women should dress the underworld might open and I be transported therein.

It's really great when someone knows how to dress, not in the sense that they show off the latest high-street brand in the style of the season, but in the sense that they are familiar with the underlying considerations which are slightly more permanent than satchels being hot this season. This is not an attempt on my behalf to police people's wardrobes, although I concede mild frustration with the ecological effects of certain style selections, rather, it is an earnest attempt to explain what I do when dressing, in the hopes others may take some principles from this text and apply it to rendering themselves all the more beautiful. We should not judge books by their covers, but absent any other information about people, what are we to form our judgments on, besides how they've put themselves together that morning? There are many who will continue dressing in athletic wear, with graphics, and no intention of exercising, and I encourage these individuals to be true to themselves and contribute to the world in whatever ways they feel they are best placed to do so; I won't judge unduly. It must be owned, however, that judgments are human and we cannot help but make them, only ever hoping that they continue to be made rationally and ethically rather than reactively, and accordingly, if we seek to modify our standing in others' eyes, we might find some fashion theory not altogether unwelcome.

‘Further Fashioning’ Try to stand out, for the sake of us all — there is too much mediocre dressing afoot, ahead, and a-every other body part which may be wrapped in cloth, but with a few major considerations sorted out, we may be able to muddle our way towards some really snazzy looks. By dressing well we contribute to the communal aesthetic of the street, which is to say society writ-large, and we ensure the continued development of sartorial arts. In the previous essay, I reviewed a few major considerations to bear in mind when considering how to construct outfits from scratch, but due to the sheer voluminousness of the material in question, and the amount to which I must rationalize my own predilection for shopping, there are some other points which I will expand on here. Further essays may break down material only nodded at here, due to sentence constraints (five by five, you know), but these are the next most pertinent points I would encourage any novice dresser to consider. There are three further major style groups which can be added to the previous list; there is the consideration of fit to be explored, and there is the integration of accessories and body modifications to be analyzed.

The three major other styles to be considered are casual wear, sleepwear, and genre style, each of which has hallmarks, but which will often proceed by degrees one into the other, as is the manner with categories. Casual wear, including such hallmarks as cotton tees, denim pants, leather sneakers, fleece hoodies, etc. is typified by a combination of mild durability with mild comfort, and fluctuates the most depending on the influence of the other styles in the popular zeitgeist at any given time. Sleepwear is typified by a softer palette, especially for women’s sleepwear, as well as softer materials which are often thinly constructed to provide maximum comfort; it is having something of a moment at present, with the widespread acceptance that pyjama day is every day. Finally there is genre style, including such styles of dress as anime, punk, goth, and others, all of which are largely unified by their cumbersome nature, providing very little in practical considerations, but providing very impressive and committed aesthetic impacts. While these styles can be differentiated largely by the kinds of items each would characteristically espouse, there are many different manners of presenting on the continuums of styles, part of which comes down to how the items fit.

Fits are simply classified, but much more difficult to typify the aesthetic impact of, largely due to the huge amount of variation between different fits depending on the style being fitted, gender of the fitter, and the activity in question at hand. The first fit is loose, which provides ease of movement and relative comfort, but which obscures the body’s naturally pleasing contours, which may sometimes be the point, either due to an actual desire to show less, or due to a desire to be seen as wanting to show less, both of which are valid approaches. The next fit is snug, allowing relatively free movement, comfort, and a trim view of the body’s contour, which appearance as it walks the middle path tends to correspond to a certain professional or competent, respectable air. Tight clothing can restrict movement and impede comfort, but can also provide wonderful views of physical contours, if this is the desired effect, but with the acknowledged caveat that such

displays may be read as such, not that anyone has the right to judge, but people do tend to. After having selected a fit, there is the next consideration to bear in mind, how does one integrate other objects and accessories which might be conducive to the overall effect?

Accessories should be incorporated only once the basics of dress are understood, and the dresser has gotten to the point of boredom with the conventional accoutrements, desiring to expand their remit. When selecting accessories, ensure that those which will be used more regularly, such as backpacks, are more minimal, allowing them to work with a wider range of items; only if there is already a minimal version of an accessory should another be acquired. Consider what other items or aesthetic contributors need to be balanced with, as if tattoos are present of a certain style and colour, this should be followed, and if you already have a lot of a certain colour, it may be easier to match with more of that, but don't oversaturate in one tone. Finally, when considering accessories, it can be beneficial to ensure that the dresser obtains fewer high-quality items rather than more low-quality ones, as high-quality items worn sparingly tend to provide an impression of culture and restraint; which is hot. Accessories and body modifications are some of my favourite contributors to looks when properly applied, but we must always be careful not to overload the viewer, and to ensure that our aesthetics are tastefully minimal (enough).

There is nothing more pleasing than seeing someone stride down the street with full awareness of just how commanding they appear. More power to you, friend, in your earnest search to represent the beauty underneath your skin beyond it, in the language of thread and cloth, tattoo and stud; may you forever stun those who behold you. There are various other considerations for dress not engaged with here, which omissions may perhaps spur yet more writing on the topic of aesthetic construction, if I can only begin to structure the considerations into yet another five-paragraph suit. While there is nothing I prefer to seeing squads of sartorially adept and alacritous individuals at ease about the streets, I must confess there are times when I am on a promenade and I find the surroundings might be improved with just a tad more attention paid to the underlying considerations of fashioning. Here's a few thoughts, on how I like to put myself together and present different aesthetics, and while I've never tried the anime look myself, I confess that there is something particularly charming about people so committed to the bit that they are willing to look past the judgment from style sticks-in-the-mud.

'Belief Calibration' A previous work discussed the importance of the probability map concept, suggesting that this is a local field which nexuses inhabit, in which different potential timelines are existent and may be selected between with some consideration. Position on the probability map is hypothesized as being sensitive to belief, and may be entirely influenced by it, as belief is attention, which is to say the conscious selection of ken about a given subject. It has been a suspicion of mine for a while, held at appropriate epistemic arm's length, that the only thing which prevents our manifesting outcomes we desire, is our inability to truly

believe in the likelihoods of their occurrence. The question then turns into a matter of training belief, so that we don't simply tell ourselves our presents are mutable, but we viscerally sense the possibility. By convincing ourselves of our beliefs, and ensuring that we maintain appropriate systems for believing, we may be better able to select the timeline we inhabit on the probability map (if there is such a thing).

While it may be tempting to try and convince oneself of one's ability to fly, the first consideration when calibrating our belief systems is to ensure we do not deny reality, at least insofar as reality may be told to be 'real'. We must prioritize our ability to function in the real world, which is to say our actual position on the possibility map, by determining what is relatively definite, what is relatively unknown, and where the degrees are of difference between. This is because our ability to consciously select our ideal outcome for now must be prioritized above instinct, which seems reliably bestial, as we cannot trust our guts in all contexts, and must integrate feeling with thought to provide the greatest returns on our selected beliefs. This means selecting a belief interval (applying stition, a term covered in my poetic work) and applying it to the given concept's likelihood of not only occurrence, but relevance to your given situation. While it is important to ground any belief systems in the fundamental consideration of what should be believed in by virtue of its existence, there is the corollary that if belief only extends so far, it is rather agonizingly limited.

The next thing to consider when allocating belief, is not how reality is, but how we would have it be, which is to say moving from an empirical to a normative framework, without ever being wilfully ignorant of the actual state of affairs at play. We must try to believe in the likelihood and probability of our desired outcomes, and according to both the outcomes' valences of importance and depending on their perceived susceptibility to subtle forces spending more or less time with the beliefs. These beliefs may freely contradict each other; two mutually exclusive outcomes may be sought towards, though are unlikely to be achieved as such, and manifestory powers mayn't like (all matter thinks, all information likewise) to be split, but there is nothing to prevent us trying to achieve mutually exclusive outcomes, just like you can bet on both a team's victory and loss simultaneously. There comes the added caveat that there may be outcomes we think that we desire, that may in fact be disadvantageous to us in the long run, but the simulation surely wouldn't feed us rope, would it? Belief in what is desired is the true manifestory skill, but it must be balanced with the consideration for negative ramifications which can stem from manifestation as well.

The final consideration to balance when allocating belief, is the avoidance of certain topics, or to wrap a neologism around it, we must calibrate antibelief as well as belief itself, by actively avoiding the outcomes we would rather didn't come to pass. We should likely avoid dwelling on unwanted outcomes as this may result in their manifestation, which is a lot harder than it may sound, as it runs into the problem of not thinking about a pink elephant. We can

acknowledge negative possibilities, but must be careful to balance our need to analyze them to maximize odds of avoiding the harm, with the need not to think about them overly much and thereby encourage the event's occurrence. When considering likely negative outcomes, try to use a jiu-jitsu approach, by accepting the likelihood of the events' coming to pass, but trying to see how the impact can be leveraged for gain, by thinking about the negative outcome in the abstract, without concretizing it internally (for instance, feeling the upwelling of the concept, but not wrapping it in internal grammar, instead dismissing it before grammar can form and formalize the thought). While it can be difficult to avoid dwelling on outcomes we don't want to come to pass, there may be beneficial manifestory effects to only analyzing something insofar as it can be engaged with fruitfully.

The probability map is a highly speculative framework which ought to be challenged rigorously prior to any form of adoption in the general population, but if it does exist, and some of my thinking might hold water, then these are what appear to be the major considerations when modifying positioning on the map. This process may be applied to L-space navigation as well, with the added caveat that at higher levels of realitive organizations, there may be more forces at play with vested interests they seek to protect. Movement on smaller-scale probability maps may be conducive to any situation where entropy comes into play, as any cosmic dice-roll is an opportunity for us to leverage manifestation; chance can be hacked — definites don't shift. To test the framework, a practitioner might take a computer, have it simulate continuous values (say the number six, for instance), and then using a random number generator review the numbers produced, and track interesting trends. Calibrating belief is an erstwhile challenge for individuals who would like to change their prospects using little besides raw thought, but must be understood to be merely a seductive idea at this stage, and potentially not one worth bedding, but bedfellow decision are, as always, left to the reader.

'Solipsistic Integration' My first involuntary hospitalization was because I thought I was God, and because rather than politely pointing out the lack of beard on me, my connections decided to send in armed police to deal with me. It cannot be ignored that I needed help, but the help I needed was not for some thugs to hurt me and force medication on me which was ineffective to the extent, what I needed was codification and engagement with the ideas which were so compelling to me at the time. This was never provided, and so I have done the work of systematizing my thoughts in this area, in the hopes that if others are similarly stricken they might find some solace safety precautions for engaging with what are high-risk paradigms of thought. The solipsistic framework, popularized by Descartes with his thinking and thus being, and accordingly only being sure of oneself, is seductive and not entirely spurious or selfish, as many argue. Integrating a solipsistic framework into our belief systems can responsibly be done, with a few major considerations to bear in mind when so-doing, to reduce the odds of orderly intervention.

We are all degrees of player one, or the only one in existence, as hypothesized by more traditional solipsists, but must never consider ourselves as being inherently more valuable than any other human, as that way tyranny lies. The logic proceeds thusly: if the universe is a simulation, then simulating is likely a high-computationally inclined activity, and to optimize the simulation would likely only simulate one true consciousness as that is all that would be needed to obtain findings apropos the desired data. It may be that multiple consciousnesses are required by the simulation, but the more consciousnesses we add, the lower the yield of information per consciousness, due to the likelihood of overlapping data producing redundancy. It may be productive to imagine ourselves as player one, but we must balance this with wariness as to the form of thinking which that can encourage. While there is a vanishingly slim chance of being player one, and accordingly being able to manifest more due to increased consciousness, there is a far greater chance of being on the receiving end of the proverbial stick.

Just as we are all degrees of player one, we are all also degrees of NPC, as while we may feel that we have true interiority, we cannot be sure that our internal landscape is the true experience, or whether it is in fact just a pleasant fiction which we tell ourselves. If we accept that it is computationally more efficient for only one or at the very least a restricted range of solipsists to be provided true interiority, then we must accept that the odds of our being player one rather than an NPC are thin. However, applying the belief interval approach (stition again), we may more accurately find that we are degrees of NPC and degrees of player one, two, etc. This must be balanced with our earnest awareness of how much we cleave to norms versus deviate from them, as the more different we are from standards, the more likely it is that we may be in possession of higher rates of player-oneness. While it is tempting to imagine that we are the main character in the story, we must own the statistical improbability of this, and accept that odds are we're a minor character at most, but this minority may be modified with diligence.

Depending upon our awareness of our status and position in the simulation, we may be able to become more or less of a main character with effort. By acknowledging that we are on a spectrum balancing between player one and NPC, we may become closer to actually being player one, with all of the manifestory perks that may come with such a promotion. We should continue to investigate our individuality to determine how close we stand to player one status, as this will inform our degree of certainty in manifesting what we desire. Another indicator of accruing player-oneness may be experiences which are manifestly bizarre, and these should be noted and internally tracked as best the practitioner is able. By maintaining a clear-eyed awareness of our potential and our position, we may edify the position further, to the extent that we can begin to effect changes via will, which is, if not the ultimate goal, pretty darn close.

There are kinds of thinking which can be seductively self-reinforcing, such as the internal narrative which suggests one is different, special, and to be treated as such. The risk of such thinking is that we begin to dismiss others as being

less valid, assuming our experience trumps theirs, and that we have the right to impose great hardship on others to protect or encourage our piddling conveniences. Thinking that one is a deity is a surefire manner of alienating the rest of humanity, as makes abundant sense, because deities tend to be ornery creatures at the best of times, who are unwilling to brook much disagreement. The solipsistic framework, despite all these caveats, does, to my mind, hold a certain amount of water; not enough that I will ever again declare myself deified, but perhaps enough to merit the attention I've paid to the phenomenon here. Should someone begin acting deified, you could do worse than to present them this essay, which is something that I really would've appreciated being presented with, when I was in my straits.

'A Formal Indictment of Society' It may be that I stalk this earth aeons hence, nevertheless it begins to occur to me that my time left may be short. While I have enjoyed countless sunny days, where warmth dappled across me as leafy trees' canopies split the rays cascading across me, nevertheless I have endured pain and hardship. Accordingly, it has come time for me to design a will of sorts, but as I have received little besides ken in this life, I am left with little but ken to provide to the world in my absence, and I only hope that my meager contributions can prevent any losses like mine in ages hence. This is not intended to stoke the fires of division, rather it is intended as a balm in case there are those who find that in my absence, there are unanswered questions as to how they might proceed to ensure ken such as this is valued in future. The punishment for my impending death ought to be doled out according to the understanding that my death was both eminently foreseeable and preventable, not a weakness but a logical conclusion based on correct evaluation of input; that my productivity should be accounted for when determining degree of retributive loss for my passing; and that punishment for my passing ought to be applied commensurately with factors expanded upon below.

It is a foregone conclusion that I will kill myself, be it directly via a razor, noose, ledge, or some other such direct precipitation of death; or via rapid expenditure of life in self-destructive behaviours stemming from a simultaneous need for relief, and lack of regard for the experience of living, as I'm really not enjoying myself here, smile through it though I may, which is entirely understandable once you comprehend my conditions. My suicidal tendencies have been extensively documented and shared since the age of sixteen, when I wrote my first poem about suicide 'Sundays in the Tub', as can be found in my collection of poetry, which proceeds through some 75,000 words to document over a decade of ideation, amongst other things. During this time I have worked five years without more than five days off in succession, with the exception of hospital stays, and I have written, besides the aforementioned poetry, to date about 30,000 words each of essays and fable or fairytale retellings, and a short novel excerpt of about 25,000 words, alongside providing several hundred illustrations to the world, not to mention the dance videos (to reiterate, no television, social media, or video games either), all while having one friend I see for two to three hours weekly in my city. Despite this, the extent of the support I have received

is as follows: antidepressants, intern therapists on a six-month basis, to address the mental health woes, and financially I receive between three and four thousand dollars per year from the government (for which I must accept the moniker of disabled), along with working full time across two contractual teaching jobs, with a father's basement to sleep in if I must fall back on it, or an apartment 200 sq. ft. that contains everything down to the kitchen plus bathroom. To call this insufficient is an insult — this is an outrage.

When I am dead, if there is any desire to see the scales of justice properly weighted, measure me against the mean of production as understood in contributions in ken units to the collective pot, integrating the cost of my upkeep as compared to others'. Should there prove a desire, upon further reflection of any of my admittedly minor work, to pursue a judicial course against responsible parties, if I may presume so much as a possibility, then the difficulty of prosecuting according to the diffuse nature of my suffering will hamper efforts, a hampering I seek to impede here. My contributions should be understood as best they can and valued according to the economic system of the time, divided by my cost of upkeep to provide my marginal contribution to society, to determine the scale of economic loss derived from my death, with my productivity understood to be on an upward swing, as is demonstrated by the scope of my writing and other work. They should not be calculated according to a financial framework in the current sense of the word, where fact is fiction, truth is lies, and holding money means you're owed money, because you're a usurious loan-shark who relies upon force in a marketplace, at whatever scale that benefits you. Once the ken impact of my loss is calculated, please drive this energy into rehabilitative actions for society, ensuring that awareness is paid to systems supposed to support individuals such as myself, who may be able to contribute worlds more, if only someone might pick them out of the gutter long enough for them to dry.

Based upon my value in productive unit equivalents, and tying in whatever flimsy notion we may have of the worth of human life independent of its ability to contribute back, punish proportionately and with a fundamental desire for learning, depending on the individuals' standing in society, with more affluent individuals punished all the more, and individuals proportionately more likely to have been aware and been in a position to halt the tailspin apportioned a degree of punishment. In order to determine net punishment required, which should be meted out proportionately to the degree of agency, while incorporating the correctively retributinal framework which values human life independent of economic value (if my life is still understood to be human by anyone save myself), take the value of one human life and the economic value I provided as a proxy for my economic value. Punish those in positions of power, or influence, understood according to the ken units they possess, which while often very independent of financial status, to which the author personally attests, is nonetheless undeniably correlated with financial standing. Should it be found that anyone has in any manner made money off of my work, such as a boot-legger selling versions of my illustrations, or an AI company taking my writing

and using it to improve its models over the course of years without appropriate remuneration, then these individuals should be especially firmly punished, to ensure that situations such as my imminent death do not occur again. While I do not seek retribution out of a cathartic desire to soothe myself with others' pain, as such behaviour is bestial and not worthy of entertaining, nonetheless certain forms of punishment when properly applied may mend tendencies which otherwise might become aggravated.

At this late stage, I have abandoned hopes of aid; it has been too long that things have deteriorated for, and despite my best efforts to provide according to my skillset, I have found no succour for my wounds. I must reiterate that I do not seek a vulgar vengeance; I seek, as I have always tried to seek, betterment for the community I form part of, in the most general and abstract sense, and what I have taken in pursuit of that goal I repent me, asking of you forgiveness for my wants. It may be that the world is better off without me, as I cannot possibly understand all the wise machinations of a wide world, but I am certain of understanding its effects upon me, and those are not manageable, nor have they been in over a decade. Should any of what I have written be valued at any stage, and questions arise as to the necessity of my death, then I hope that the few considerations I have listed here may be borne in mind when the judicial process sluggishly clicks into gear. I am trying to cling on — I really am, and I give you my earnest word to fight the intrusive thoughts as best I am able, but if I am not able to resist them further, and one way or another I've written my last, here are some final thoughts as to aspects of my legacy.